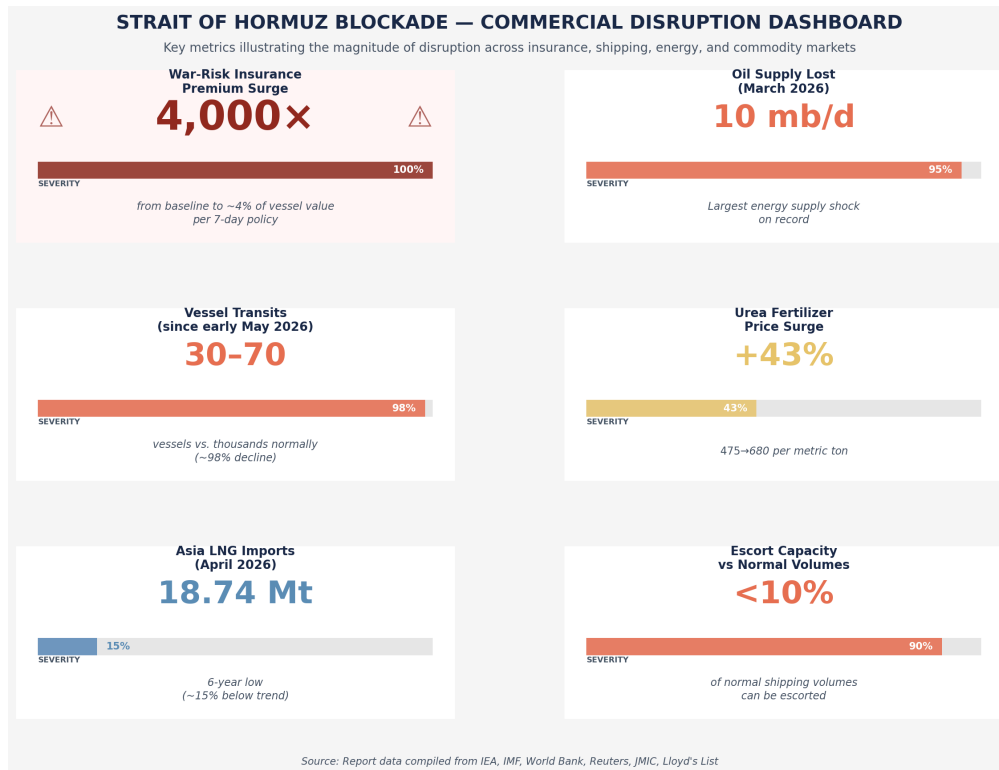


Strait of Hormuz Blockade: Resolution Scenarios

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Assumptions current as of 11 June 2026.



1. Assumptions and Evidentiary Status

Verified Facts

- 28 February 2026 closure.** Iran's Revolutionary Guards told ships that passage through the Strait of Hormuz was "not allowed," confirmed by an EU naval mission official [\[1-1\]](#). The IEA confirms the war began on 28 February 2026 and that energy trade flows through the Strait were impeded, with crude and oil product flows plunging from around 20 million barrels per day to "a trickle" [\[1-2\]](#). Reuters described a "near-total closure" as of 28 May 2026 after three months of upheaval [\[1-19\]](#). UNCTAD's June 2026 assessment confirmed the Strait remained "virtually closed" and was deepening global economic strain across trade, prices, and finance [\[3-7\]](#). The World Bank documented a loss of 10 mb/d of oil supply in March alone, calling it the largest energy supply shock on record [\[4-6\]](#).

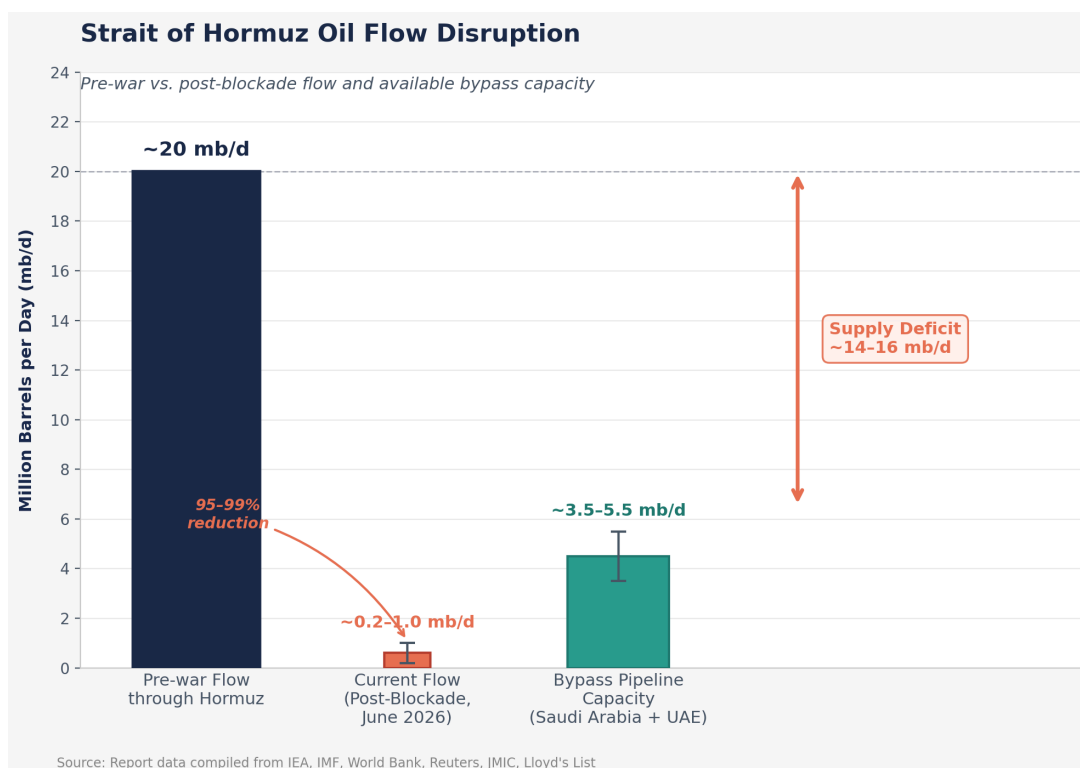
- **U.S. counter-blockade of Iranian ports, 13 April 2026.** U.S. Central Command announced it would begin implementing a blockade of all maritime traffic entering and exiting Iranian ports on 13 April 2026 [\[1-3\]](#)[\[1-4\]](#). UKMTO Advisory 035-26 and JMIC Advisory Note 002-26 both confirmed the action and clarified that neutral transit passage through the Strait to or from non-Iranian destinations was not intended to be impeded [\[1-5\]](#)[\[1-6\]](#).
- **Pakistan-hosted diplomacy and multi-party mediation.** China and Pakistan publicly called for an immediate ceasefire and normal navigation in the Strait on 31 March 2026 [\[1-7\]](#). U.S. and Iranian negotiators held high-level talks in Pakistan on 10–11 April 2026, with Tehran's agenda including transit fees in the Strait [\[1-8\]](#)[\[1-9\]](#).
- **Oman actively building a safe-passage mechanism.** Oman's Foreign Minister Sayyid Badr Albusaidi stated officially that Oman is "working intensively to put in place safe passage arrangements for the Strait of Hormuz" [\[5-1\]](#). Oman and Iran held deputy foreign minister-level talks on options to ensure the "smooth transit of vessels" through the Strait [\[5-2\]](#).
- **Draft reopening framework, late May.** On 27 May 2026 Iranian state TV described a draft framework under which Tehran would restore shipping through the Strait to pre-war levels within one month if terms were agreed. Simultaneously, U.S. strikes in southern Iran and drone interceptions continued [\[1-10\]](#).
- **Transit-fee concept, 8 June 2026.** Iran's ambassador to Moscow stated the Strait would be open under new conditions set by Iran and Oman, including a transit fee [\[1-11\]](#).
- **OFAC sanctions alert directly targeting the transit-fee concept.** OFAC issued an alert warning both U.S. and non-U.S. persons of sanctions risks from making payments to, or seeking guarantees from, the Iranian regime for safe passage through the Strait of Hormuz [\[6-1\]](#). This creates a concrete legal contradiction with Iran's publicly stated reopening mechanism.
- **UN Security Council action.** A Security Council document dated 7 April 2026 condemns actions aimed at closing or obstructing international navigation through the Strait of Hormuz [\[4-1\]](#). The Secretary-General stated that navigational rights and freedoms through the Strait must be respected, as affirmed by Council resolution 2817 (2026) [\[4-2\]](#). The Secretary-General also described the maritime corridor in the Strait of Hormuz as a pre-existing joint Oman–Iran mechanism established in 1968, calling it "a mandatory mechanism" under the International Convention for the Safety of Life at Sea [\[7-2\]](#). This gives a legal-institutional basis for an Oman-linked

reopening format anchored in an existing international framework, rather than an ad hoc invention.

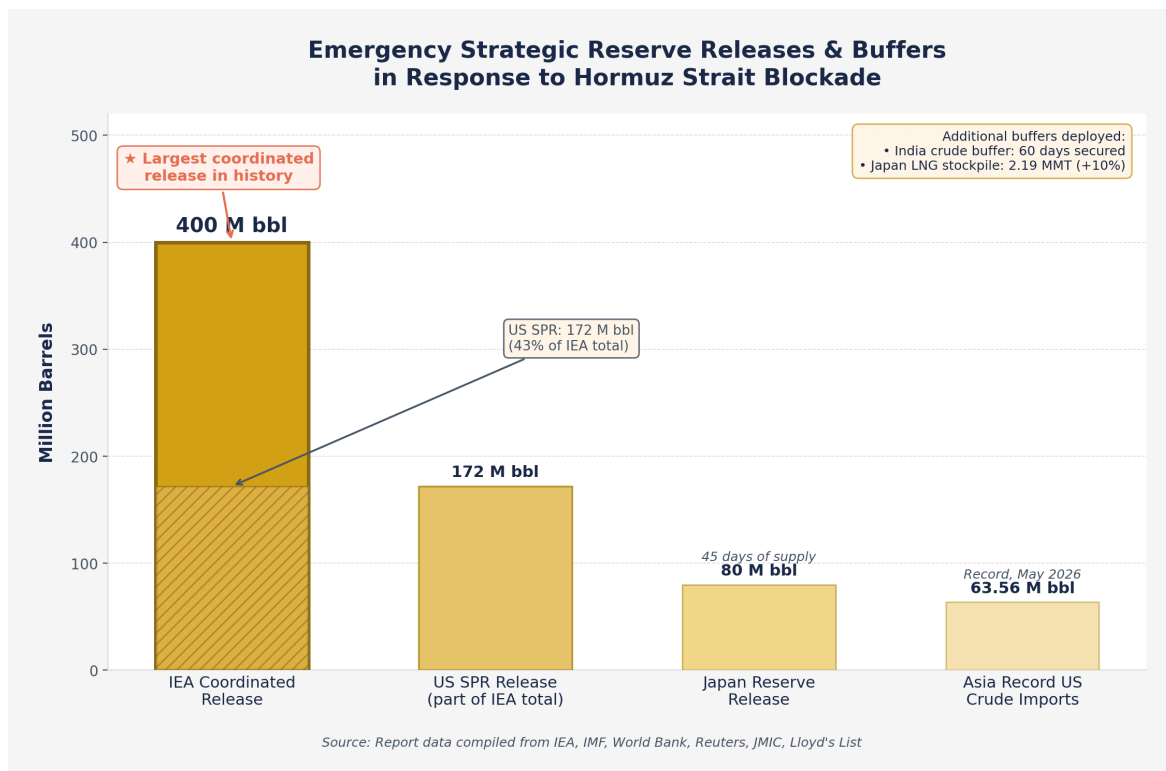
- **Continuing maritime insecurity and mine threat.** At least 20 maritime security incidents occurred in the Arabian Gulf, Strait of Hormuz, and Gulf of Oman since 1 March 2026 [\[1-13\]](#). UKMTO advisories and MARAD advisory 2026-0001B confirm significant military activity continued through at least 8 June 2026 [\[1-12\]](#)[\[1-14\]](#). Critically, JMIC Update 056 dated 9 June 2026 states that "mining in and near the TSS remains a threat, and GNSS interference is consistent" [\[7-1\]](#). This confirms that the mine threat is not abstract but is actively shaping which navigation lanes are usable, and that electronic interference adds a separate operational barrier to safe navigation.
- **Current traffic is already routing through Omani territorial waters south of the normal Traffic Separation Scheme (TSS).** JMIC Update 056 states that "Strait of Hormuz traffic remains significantly reduced, with commercial vessels continuing to route south of the TSS via Omani territorial waters" [\[7-1\]](#). This is a concrete operational fact that defines the physical geometry of any near-term reopening: vessels that are transiting are already using a specific southern/Omani workaround lane, not the standard pre-war navigation channels.
- **Extremely limited actual vessel transits.** Only roughly 30 to 70 vessels had crossed the Strait since early May 2026, some with U.S. military guidance or helicopter escorts [\[2-3\]](#). No formal escort system had been launched as of reporting [\[2-5\]](#). Two India-bound LPG tankers carrying about 94,000 metric tons safely transited the Strait in late March 2026 [\[5-7\]](#). The JMIC routing detail [\[7-1\]](#) provides the mechanism for how these selective transits have been possible: vessels can use a constrained southern lane through Omani waters while the main TSS area remains mined or otherwise operationally degraded.
- **War-risk insurance repricing and structural changes are binding constraints on commercial traffic.** Insurance costs surged up to 4,000 times pre-crisis levels, with seven-day policies priced around 4% of vessel value [\[2-3\]](#)[\[2-4\]](#). Britannia P&I's war-risk note states that ordinary P&I cover does not automatically apply to war losses and that special buy-back arrangements are required, with exclusions for U.S./UK/Israeli-owned, flagged, operated, or affiliated vessels [\[2-1\]](#). Steamship Mutual confirms conditions remain highly constrained [\[2-2\]](#). Major marine insurers issued formal cancellation notices and restructured policy terms: Gard received notice of cancellation from reinsurers for war risks in Iran and the Persian/Arabian Gulf and issued cancellation notices effective 5 March 2026, before reinstatement on

revised terms [6-4]. London P&I similarly cancelled cover for certain war risks tied to Iran and defined Persian/Arabian Gulf waters [6-5].

- **Joint War Committee expanded listed areas beyond Iran to the broader Gulf region.** JWC circular JWLA-033 dated 3 March 2026 added Bahrain, Djibouti, Kuwait, Oman, and Qatar to listed areas and amended the wider Persian/Arabian Gulf, Gulf of Oman, Indian Ocean, Gulf of Aden, and Southern Red Sea risk zone [6-2]. TT Club updated its excluded areas effective 12 March 2026 accordingly [6-3].
- **Charterparty law gives shipowners formal rights to refuse Gulf voyages.** BIMCO advised owners and charterers to review VOYWAR 2025 and CONWARTIME 2025, noting that owners may be entitled to refuse or withdraw from voyages if vessel, cargo, or crew may be exposed to war risks [6-6]. NorthStandard confirms owners may refuse charterers' orders if, in their reasonable judgment, the vessel, crew, or cargo may be exposed to war risks [6-7]. Japan P&I Club states that ports within the Persian Gulf are likely to be considered unsafe to reach because transiting Hormuz itself is dangerous [6-8].
- **Limited bypass capacity.** Only Saudi Arabia and the UAE have operational crude pipelines that could reroute some flows, with estimated available capacity of 3.5 to 5.5 mb/d—well below the approximately 20 mb/d that transited the Strait before the war [1-15].



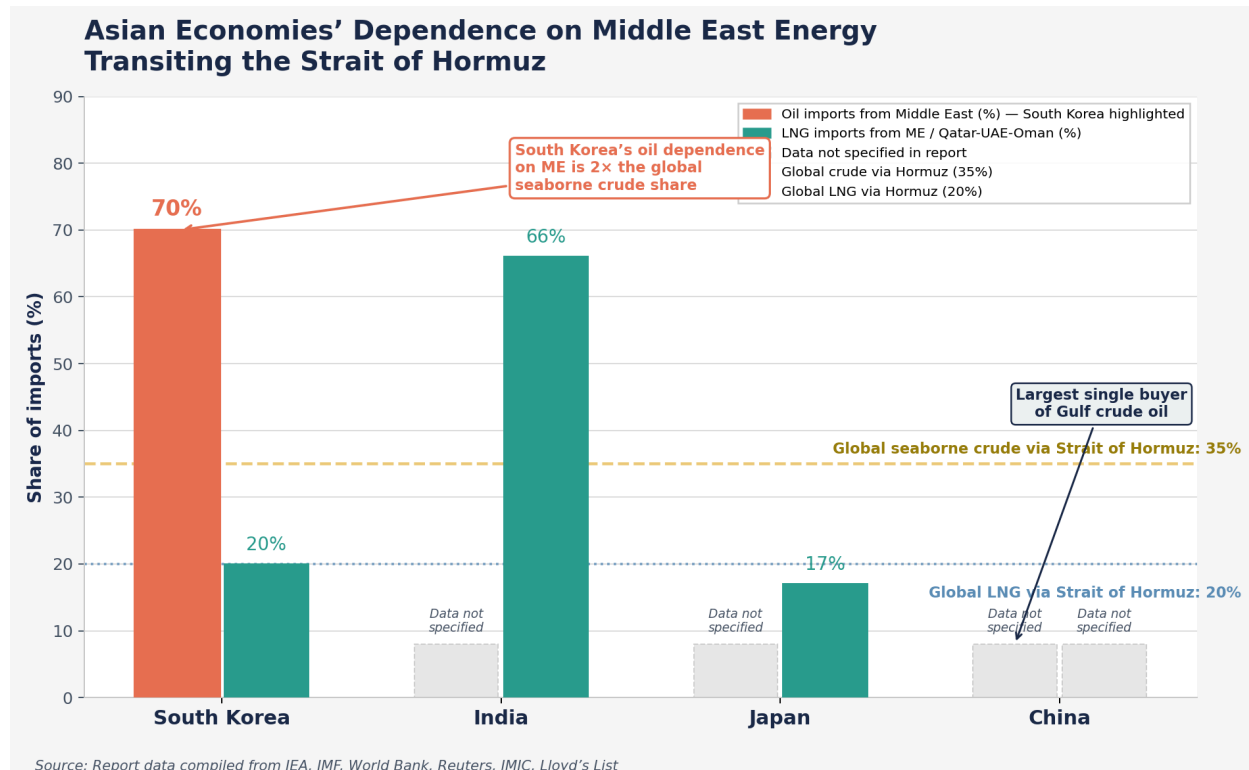
- **Escort capacity severely limited.** Lloyd's List reported that naval escorts would cap tanker transits at under 10% of normal volumes and that no escort system had yet been launched because of political, logistical, and security obstacles. Even minimal Iranian mine-laying could halt all traffic again [2-5].
- **Broad international coalition forming.** Britain, France, Germany, Italy, the Netherlands, and Japan publicly stated their readiness to contribute to efforts to ensure safe passage through the Strait and to stabilize energy markets [3-3].
- **Historic emergency oil-stock releases underway.** Japan announced a release of approximately 80 million barrels from strategic reserves, equivalent to 45 days of supply [3-1]. The United States was releasing 172 million barrels from the SPR as part of an IEA-coordinated 400 million barrel release—the largest in history [3-2].



- **Crude substitution occurring but quantitatively insufficient.** Asia's imports of U.S. crude reached a record 63.56 million barrels in May 2026, but Reuters assessed that these higher U.S. volumes cannot offset the loss of crude cargoes from the effective closure of Hormuz [3-4]. The World Bank confirmed that the global outlook depends on the speed and scale of the return of shipping through Hormuz, not merely alternative sourcing [4-6].
- **Asian LNG demand collapsed and is only partially recovering.** Asia's LNG imports fell to a six-year low of 18.74 million tonnes in April 2026 after the effective closure of

Hormuz and the stoppage of Qatari shipments [\[3-5\]](#). Partial recovery was expected by June as China resumed some buying [\[3-5\]](#).

- **Qatar's liquefaction shutdown creates a separate bottleneck.** Qatar fully shut gas liquefaction and required at least weeks to restart [\[3-6\]](#). QatarEnergy extended force majeure on LNG supplies to Edison until at least mid-August 2026, with 17 cargoes affected [\[5-12\]](#)[\[5-13\]](#).
- **China-Iran bilateral talks on safe passage.** China was in talks with Iran to allow safe passage for crude oil and Qatari LNG vessels through Hormuz [\[5-9\]](#).
- **China's refinery system directly affected.** China's oil imports fell to the lowest level in almost four years in April 2026 [\[5-10\]](#). China maintained tight fuel export quotas [\[5-11\]](#).
- **India operating on multi-month emergency planning horizons.** India secured crude oil supplies for 60 days [\[5-4\]](#) and was scouting alternative crude and LPG sources [\[5-5\]](#). India's government asked state oil marketing companies to build LPG reserves equal to at least 30 days of demand, with LPG identified as the most affected energy segment [\[5-8\]](#).
- **Japan managing LNG as a distinct risk channel.** Japanese utilities increased LNG stockpiles by 10% to 2.19 million metric tons, while METI saw no calls for emergency supply at that stage [\[5-3\]](#).
- **Prewar Hormuz trade shares.** Before the conflict, vessels transiting Hormuz accounted for nearly 35% of global seaborne crude oil trade, 20% of refined petroleum product trade, and about 20% of LNG trade [\[4-6\]](#). The EIA states that 2024 oil flow through the Strait averaged 20 million barrels per day [\[1-16\]](#).
- **Asian import dependence.** South Korea sources roughly 70% of its oil and 20% of its LNG from the Middle East [\[1-17\]](#). India sourced about two-thirds of its LNG from Qatar, the UAE, and Oman [\[1-17\]](#). Japan imported 3.4 million metric tons of LNG from Qatar in 2025; Qatar, the UAE, and Oman combined accounted for 17% of Japan's LNG imports [\[1-18\]](#).



- Broad non-oil downstream disruption.** The Fertilizer Institute stated that cargo insurance cancellations were forcing vessel operators to cancel fertilizer shipments [2-6]. UNCTAD documented that the Strait carries significant volumes of fertilizers [2-7][2-8]. Urea prices rose from \$475 to \$680 per metric ton [2-9], a near-46% month-on-month surge confirmed by the World Bank [4-7]. Methanol, aluminium, and sulphur trade flows through Hormuz were also disrupted [2-10].
- Multilateral institutions treat the blockade as a systemic macroeconomic shock.** The IMF described the de facto closure of Hormuz as producing the largest disruption to the global oil market in history [4-3][4-4]. The IMF's adverse scenario assumes oil prices rising 80% and gas prices 160% from Q2 2026 [4-5]. The ADB projects that food, fertilizer, and gas prices will remain persistently higher over 2026–2027 under non-early-stabilization scenarios [4-8][4-9]. The Monetary Authority of Singapore warned that current market resilience reflects buffers and that without durable reopening, the next stage of impact could be more severe [4-11].

Working Assumptions (Accepted for Analysis but Not Fully Verified)

- Reported death of Supreme Leader Ali Khamenei.** The user-provided claim that Khamenei died in connection with U.S./Israeli strikes is not independently verified in the retrieved source set. Sources confirm a regional war and U.S./Israeli strikes on

Iran but do not confirm or deny Khamenei's death [\[1-2\]](#)[\[1-10\]](#). This claim is treated as unverified; if true, it would materially affect the internal Iranian decision-making calculus.

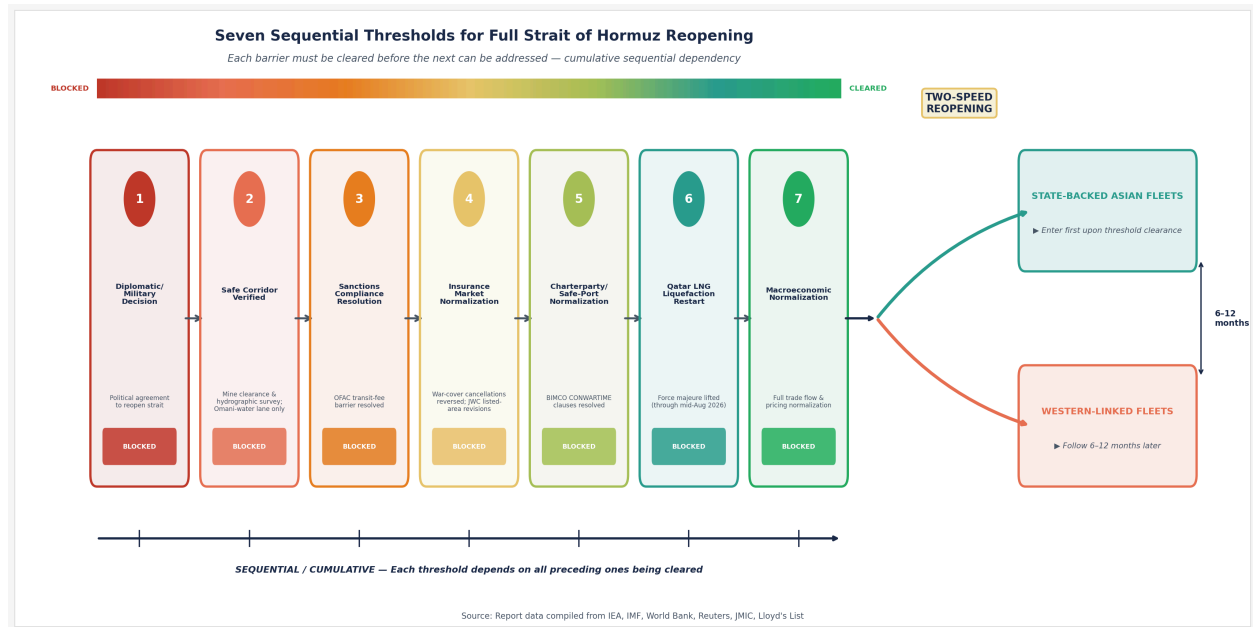
- **Pakistan-mediated talks broke down around 1 June 2026.** Pakistan-hosted diplomacy is verified, but a specific breakdown around 1 June was not confirmed [\[1-7\]](#)[\[1-8\]](#)[\[1-9\]](#). The 8 June Iranian ambassador statement suggesting reopening under new conditions [\[1-11\]](#) may indicate talks continued in some form, possibly shifting venues or formats. Oman's intensified safe-passage diplomacy [\[5-1\]](#)[\[5-2\]](#) suggests the mediation track has shifted toward Muscat rather than collapsed entirely.
- **Flows down approximately 95–99%.** The IEA's characterization of flows falling to "a trickle," Reuters' description of "near-total closure" as of 28 May [\[1-2\]](#)[\[1-19\]](#), UNCTAD's June characterization of the Strait as "virtually closed" [\[3-7\]](#), the World Bank's documentation of 10 mb/d lost in March [\[4-6\]](#), and the reporting that only 30–70 vessels transited since early May [\[2-3\]](#) directionally support this magnitude. The JMIC confirmation that traffic "remains significantly reduced" and routes through a constrained southern workaround lane [\[7-1\]](#) is consistent with a 95–99% reduction rather than absolute zero.
- **Full normalization may not occur before 2027.** No retrieved official or market source provides this specific dated forecast. However, the ADB's projection of persistently higher prices through 2026–2027 [\[4-9\]](#), the IMF's adverse scenario extending through 2027 [\[4-5\]](#), extreme insurance repricing [\[2-3\]](#)[\[2-4\]](#), formal war-cover cancellations [\[6-4\]](#)[\[6-5\]](#), expanded JWC listed areas [\[6-2\]](#)[\[6-3\]](#), charterparty refusal rights [\[6-6\]](#)[\[6-7\]](#)[\[6-8\]](#), OFAC sanctions barriers [\[6-1\]](#), escort capacity capped below 10% of normal volumes [\[2-5\]](#), persistent mining near the TSS and GNSS interference [\[7-1\]](#), Qatar's liquefaction restart timeline [\[3-6\]](#), and QatarEnergy force majeure through at least mid-August 2026 [\[5-12\]](#)[\[5-13\]](#) collectively make this a well-supported inference. The physical evidence that current traffic is funneled through a narrow southern workaround lane in Omani waters [\[7-1\]](#)—rather than using the standard TSS—underscores that even the navigational infrastructure for normal throughput does not yet exist.

Analyst Inference

- The coexistence of a draft reopening framework (27 May) and continued military strikes on the same date [\[1-10\]](#), followed by the transit-fee concept articulated on 8 June [\[1-11\]](#), indicates that Iran is simultaneously maintaining military leverage and exploring negotiated exit ramps. The diplomatic track has not collapsed entirely, but

the gap between stated positions remains wide—and has been widened further by OFAC's explicit sanctions alert targeting the transit-fee mechanism [6-1].

- Oman's role is not merely diplomatic: it is operational and geographic. The JMIC evidence that vessels are already routing south of the TSS through Omani territorial waters [7-1], combined with Oman's official safe-passage preparations [5-1] and the UN Secretary-General's reference to the 1968 joint Oman–Iran maritime corridor as a pre-existing mandatory mechanism [7-2], means that the most concrete near-term end-state is a **regulated Omani-linked southern transit corridor**. This is not a theoretical construct but a description of what is already happening at minimal scale. The practical form of reopening will be spatially specific—channelized through Omani waters south of the mined TSS—before it becomes a general restoration of bidirectional commercial traffic across all standard lanes.
- The blockade's end, for commercial purposes, will not be a single binary event. It will proceed through at least three distinct nautical states, now supported by verified operational evidence:
- **State A (current baseline):** Near-closure with exceptional transits only, routed south of the TSS via Omani territorial waters [7-1]. Throughput under 1% of pre-war levels.
- **State B (early reopening):** Limited corridor operations via Omani waters south of the TSS, with persistent mining and GNSS threats near standard lanes [7-1]. Politically arranged and state-backed cargoes transit; commercial participation constrained by insurance, sanctions, and charterparty barriers. Throughput 2–10% of pre-war levels.
- **State C (broad normalization):** Restoration of normal TSS usage and commercial navigation patterns after mine clearance, GNSS interference reduction, insurance policy restructuring, JWC listed-area revisions, and charterparty safe-port reassessments. Throughput approaches pre-war levels.



- Beyond these nautical states, seven distinct commercial thresholds must be crossed sequentially: (i) a diplomatic or military decision to reopen; (ii) a navigationally safe corridor verified by mine clearance and hydrographic survey—currently only the southern Omani-water lane qualifies [7-1]; (iii) resolution of the sanctions-compliance barrier around transit fees [6-1]; (iv) insurance market normalization, requiring reversal of formal war-cover cancellations and listed-area expansions [6-4] [6-5] [6-2] [6-3]; (v) charterparty and safe-port normalization [6-6] [6-7] [6-8]; (vi) for LNG, the restart of Qatari liquefaction facilities [3-6] [5-12] [5-13]; and (vii) macroeconomic normalization [4-4] [4-5] [4-9]. The practical consequence is a **two-speed reopening**: state-backed, less-sanctions-exposed fleets (principally Chinese, Indian, and some GCC-flagged vessels) will re-enter the corridor before Western-linked owners, banks, and insurers do.
- Emergency reserves and substitution flows are finite but meaningful. Japan's 80-million-barrel release [3-1], the IEA's 400-million-barrel coordinated draw [3-2], India's 60-day crude buffer [5-4], and record U.S. crude flows to Asia [3-4] collectively buy time for diplomacy. However, the IMF [4-4], ADB [4-9], and Singapore MAS [4-11] all document that these buffers are depleting and that the economic damage worsens over time, creating a ticking clock measured in quarters, not years.

2. Base Case

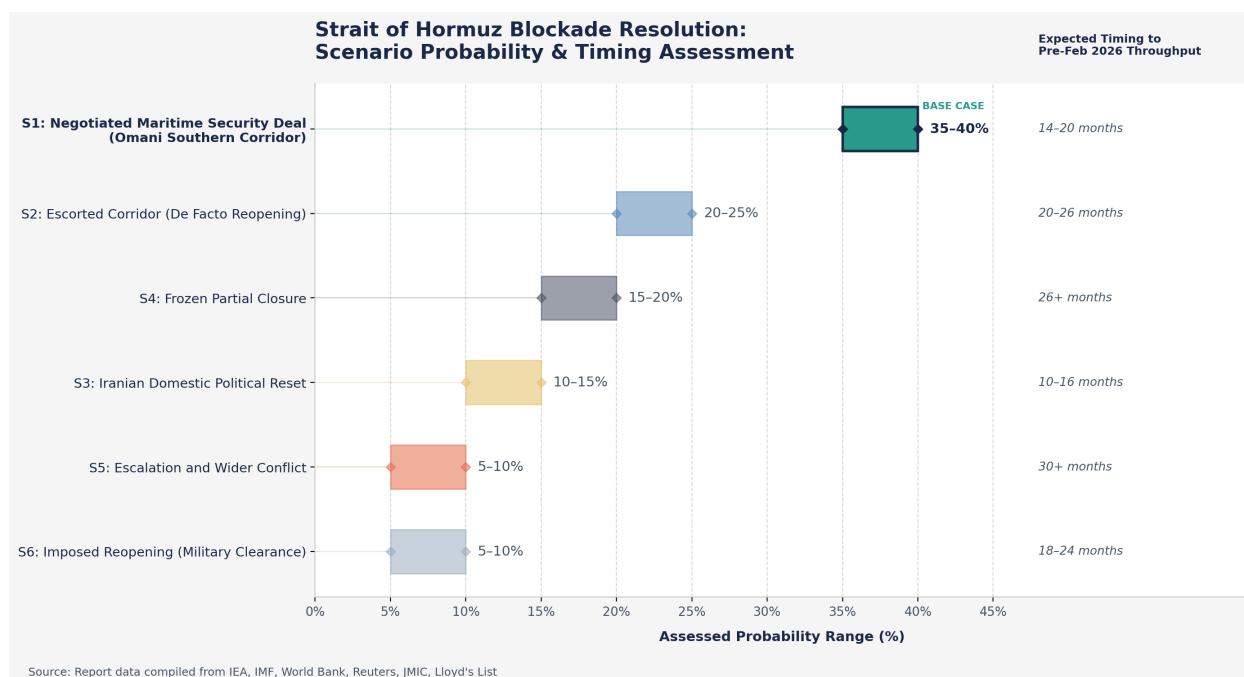
The most likely resolution path is an **Omani-co-managed, phased maritime-security deal** that formalizes and expands the southern transit corridor already in use through Omani territorial waters south of the mined TSS [7-1]. The deal will incorporate an Iranian-demanded transit-fee arrangement structured through an Omani intermediary entity to navigate U.S. sanctions constraints [6-1], and will be backed by a multinational coalition operating under the umbrella of UN Security Council resolution 2817 (2026) [4-1][4-2] and anchored in the pre-existing 1968 joint Oman–Iran maritime corridor framework referenced by the UN Secretary-General [7-2]. Oman's official preparation of "safe passage arrangements" [5-1], its deputy-level talks with Iran on "smooth transit" [5-2], Iran's publicly articulated draft reopening framework [1-10] and transit-fee concept [1-11], and China's parallel bilateral talks with Iran on safe passage for crude and Qatari LNG vessels [5-9] provide the operational and diplomatic scaffolding.

The resulting reopening will be **geographically asymmetric, commercially segmented, and jurisdiction-dependent**. The initial safe lane will be the Omani-water route south of the TSS [7-1], not the standard pre-war navigation channels, which remain compromised by mining and GNSS interference [7-1]. State-backed Asian fleets and entities less exposed to U.S. sanctions will transit first; Western-linked owners, charterers, banks, and insurers will follow only after sanctions clarity, insurance policy restructuring, JWC listed-area revisions [6-2][6-3], and charterparty safe-port reassessments [6-6][6-7][6-8] converge—a process that will lag the political agreement by 6–12 months.

Initial meaningful reopening—small numbers of monitored vessels carrying priority cargoes through the southern Omani-water corridor—will begin within 2–4 months of a framework agreement (potentially late Q3 or Q4 2026), building on the precedent of Indian LPG tankers transiting in late March [5-6][5-7] and the 30–70 vessels that crossed since early May [2-3]. Initial flows will represent well under 10% of pre-war throughput given escort capacity constraints [2-5] and extreme war-risk insurance costs [2-3][2-4]. Substantial crude oil recovery to 10–12 mb/d will require 9–15 months after a framework agreement as mine clearance progresses in the main TSS channels [7-1], insurance markets recalibrate [6-4][6-5], JWC listed areas are revised [6-2][6-3], and escort capacity scales. LNG recovery will lag crude oil recovery by an additional 3–5 months because Qatar's liquefaction restart is a separate bottleneck [3-6] and QatarEnergy has extended force majeure through at least mid-August 2026 [5-12][5-13]. Restoration to approximately pre-February-2026 total throughput of ~20 mb/d is unlikely before late 2027 at the earliest and more probably extends into H1 2028, given the layered legal-commercial frictions and the need to restore the full TSS navigation system beyond the current Omani-water workaround [7-1]. The highest-leverage uncertainty is whether Iran's internal political authority structure—potentially destabilized if Khamenei's death is confirmed—can produce a unified negotiating position and enforce compliance with any deal, including

the cessation of IRGC mine-laying and coastal harassment that is the precondition for insurance normalization.

3. Scenario Comparison Table



Scenario	Probability	Expected Timing to ~Pre-Feb-2026 Throughput	Defining Trigger/Mechanism	Net Impact
1. Negotiated Maritime Security Deal (Omani	35 – 40 %	14–20 months (late 2027–H1 2028)	Oman-brokered safe-passage framework formalizing southern corridor [7-1]; transit fee via Omani intermediary; multinational escort under	Moderate recovery; two-speed reopening by jurisdiction; elevated freight/insurance 12–24 months; LNG lags crude 3–5 months;

Scenario	Probability	Expected Timing to ~Pre-Feb-2026 Throughput	Defining Trigger/Mechanism	Net Impact
Southern Corridor)			UNSC 2817; China bilateral carve-outs; OFAC licensing	non-oil commodities lag further
2. Escorted Corridor (De Facto Reopening)	20 – 25 %	20–26 months (H1–H2 2028)	U.S./allied naval escorts expand southern corridor without formal Iranian consent; avoids transit-fee sanctions problem but faces all other legal-commercial barriers	Under 10% initial throughput [2-5] ; persistent mine/GNSS risk [7-1] ; extreme war-risk premiums; charterparty refusal rights exercised
3. Iranian Domestic Political Reset	10 – 15 %	10–16 months (Q2–Q4 2027)	Internal power transition produces new leadership willing to reopen on softer terms; mine-laying ceases; full TSS restoration accelerated	Fastest potential normalization; dependent on unverified succession dynamics
4. Frozen Partial Closure	15 – 20 %	26+ months (2028 or later)	No deal; low-level hostilities continue; trickle of bilateral/state-backed traffic through southern Omani-water lane [7-1] ; SPR drawdowns and substitution extend tolerance; legal-commercial barriers prevent broader flows	Prolonged supply deficit; structural price elevation; fertilizer/food-security crisis; reserve depletion

Scenario	Probability	Expected Timing to ~Pre-Feb-2026 Throughput	Defining Trigger/Mechanism	Net Impact
5. Escalation and Wider Conflict	5–10 %	30+ months (2028+)	Major military escalation collapses talks and widens conflict	Severe global recession risk; emergency rationing; IMF adverse scenario realized in full
6. Imposed Reopening (Military Clearance)	5–10 %	18–24 months (mid-2027–mid-2028)	U.S./coalition forcibly clears mines from TSS, suppresses Iranian coastal defenses	Rapid but contested flow restoration; mine clearance of full TSS is the binding constraint [7-1] ; extreme insurance costs; charterparty refusals persist

4. Scenario Details

Scenario 1 — Negotiated Maritime Security Deal (Omani Southern Corridor)

Defining mechanism. A diplomatic agreement—building on the draft framework reported on 27 May [\[1-10\]](#), the transit-fee concept of 8 June [\[1-11\]](#), and Oman's officially declared safe-passage preparations [\[5-1\]](#)[\[5-2\]](#)—formalizes and expands the southern transit corridor already in use through Omani territorial waters south of the mined TSS [\[7-1\]](#). The deal rests on the pre-existing 1968 joint Oman–Iran maritime corridor framework referenced by the UN Secretary-General as a mandatory mechanism under the

International Convention for the Safety of Life at Sea [7-2], giving it institutional and legal depth that a wholly novel arrangement would lack. The agreement involves Omani co-management of the corridor, a per-barrel or per-vessel transit fee payable through an Omani-administered intermediary entity to mitigate U.S. sanctions constraints [6-1], partial easing of the U.S. counter-blockade on Iranian ports, and mutual de-escalation commitments. Pakistan, China, or the UN serve as guarantors or facilitators [1-7][1-8]. UN Security Council resolution 2817 (2026) [4-1][4-2] provides the multilateral legal umbrella. The broad coalition of European nations and Japan [3-3] provides a multinational operational base. China's bilateral talks with Iran on safe passage for crude and Qatari LNG vessels [5-9] produce importer-specific carve-outs that precede or complement the broader framework.

The sanctions-compliance design problem. OFAC's explicit alert warning of sanctions risks from payments or guarantees to Iran for safe passage [6-1] means that the transit-fee mechanism—central to Iran's publicly stated reopening terms [1-11]—cannot be implemented through direct payment to the Iranian government or IRGC without exposing participants to sanctions risk. The most likely resolution is a structured arrangement in which Oman collects and administers the fee through an entity that is not designated under U.S. sanctions. Oman's geographic position controlling the southern side of the Strait, its official mediator role [5-1], and its pre-existing joint corridor framework with Iran [7-2] make it the natural intermediary. Alternatively, OFAC could issue a specific license authorizing transit-fee payments under defined conditions. Either path adds weeks to months of legal-diplomatic negotiation beyond the security terms. Without such a workaround, the corridor would reopen physically but remain commercially narrow for Western-linked fleets. Chinese and Indian state-backed entities, which face lower secondary-sanctions risk, would transit earlier.

The geographic form of reopening. The JMIC evidence that current traffic already routes south of the TSS via Omani territorial waters [7-1] means the negotiated corridor would not be a hypothetical construct but a formalization of an existing operational pattern. The main TSS channels remain compromised by mining and GNSS interference [7-1]. The initial safe lane will therefore be the Omani-water route, with gradual expansion to standard lanes only after mine clearance and GNSS normalization. This spatially specific form of reopening means that throughput recovery is constrained not only by diplomatic and commercial factors but by the physical capacity of a single narrow lane.

Probability and reasoning: 35–40%. This is the most likely single scenario for seven independently grounded reasons:

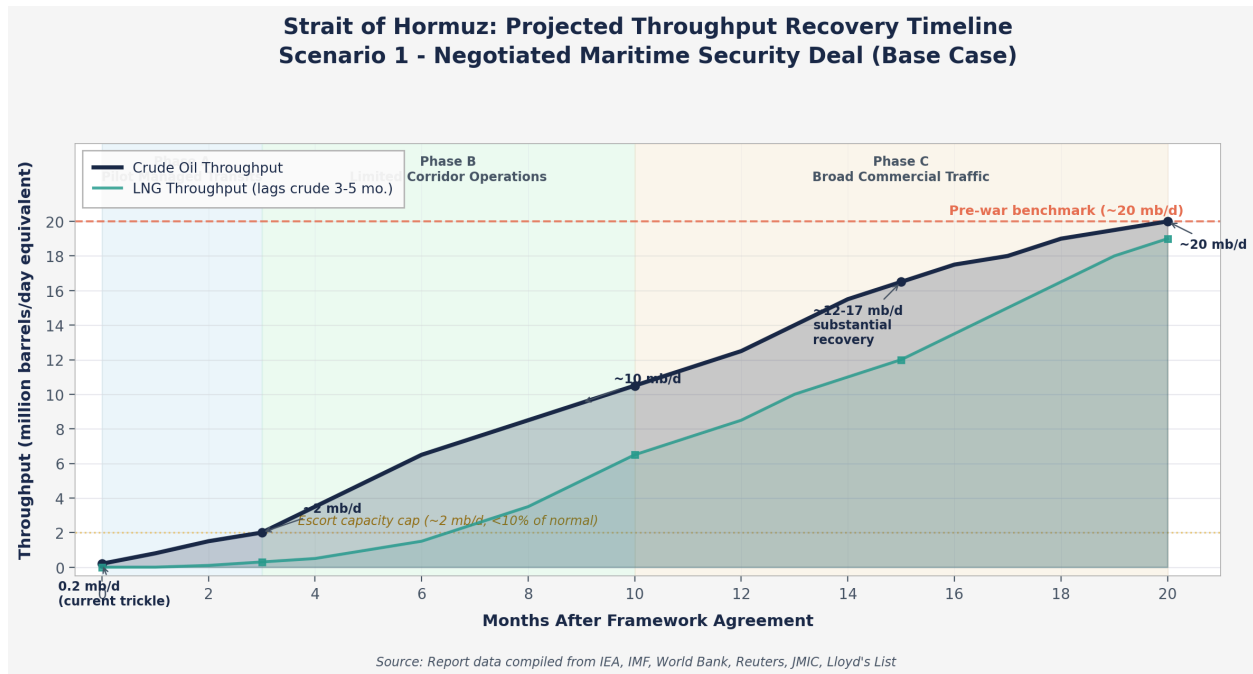
1. *A practical Omani-water routing pattern already exists.* Vessels are already transiting south of the TSS through Omani territorial waters [7-1], demonstrating that the geographic foundation for a formalized corridor is operational, not theoretical.
2. *Active diplomatic scaffolding exists.* The draft reopening framework [1-10], the transit-fee concept [1-11], Oman's official safe-passage preparations [5-1], Oman-Iran deputy-level talks [5-2], and the 1968 joint corridor framework [7-2] collectively demonstrate that the operational architecture is being built on institutional foundations.
3. *Multiple mediation channels remain open.* Pakistan hosted talks in April [1-8][1-9]; Oman is now the primary mediator [5-1][5-2]; China is pursuing bilateral carve-outs with Iran [5-9].
4. *Economic pressure is intensifying and documented.* The IMF [4-3][4-4], World Bank [4-6], ADB [4-9], UNCTAD [3-7], and Singapore MAS [4-11] all document worsening economic strain. Emergency reserves are finite [3-1][3-2].
5. *The breadth of downstream disruption widens the coalition demanding resolution.* Fertilizer trade disruption [2-6][2-7][4-7], methanol and sulphur impacts [2-10], and LPG shortages [5-8] mean agricultural economies and food-security-sensitive governments join energy importers in pressing for a deal.
6. *Selective passage already occurs.* Indian LPG tankers transited in late March [5-6][5-7]; 30–70 vessels have crossed since early May [2-3], using the southern Omani-water lane [7-1].
7. *The sanctions-compliance problem is solvable.* Omani intermediation is a natural fit given Oman's official role [5-1], its geographic control of the southern corridor [7-1], and the 1968 framework [7-2].

However, continued military strikes alongside diplomacy [1-10], the unresolved question of Iranian internal authority, OFAC sanctions barriers [6-1], and persistent mine/GNSS threats [7-1] reduce confidence in rapid conclusion.

Expected timeline:

- *Initial meaningful reopening:* 2–4 months after framework agreement (potentially late Q4 2026 if agreement is reached in Q3). Initial flows severely constrained: escort capacity caps tanker transits at under 10% of normal volumes [2-5], insurance at ~4% of vessel value per seven-day policy [2-4] limits commercial participation, and charterparty refusal rights [6-6][6-7][6-8] mean that many owners will decline Gulf voyages. The earliest transits will be politically arranged, government-backed movements of priority cargoes through the Omani-water southern lane [7-1] by state-owned or state-chartered vessels—principally Chinese, Indian, and GCC-flagged. Throughput: under 2 mb/d.

- *Substantial crude oil recovery (10–12 mb/d)*: 9–15 months after agreement. Requires: (a) mine-clearance operations to certify primary TSS channels safe, beyond the current Omani-water workaround [7-1]; (b) GNSS interference to subside or be mitigated [7-1]; (c) war-risk insurance premiums to decline and formal war-cover cancellations [6-4][6-5] to be reversed; (d) JWC listed-area designations [6-2][6-3] to be revised; (e) escort capacity to scale; (f) charterparty safe-port assessments [6-6][6-7][6-8] to shift as incident rates decline.
- *LNG recovery to pre-crisis levels*: Lags crude oil by 3–5 months. Qatar's liquefaction shutdown requires at least weeks to restart [3-6], with additional time for full ramp-up. QatarEnergy's force-majeure extension through at least mid-August 2026 [5-12][5-13] provides a concrete marker. Asia's LNG imports fell to a six-year low of 18.74 million tonnes in April [3-5], reflecting an upstream production halt, not just a shipping disruption.
- *LPG recovery*: Follows a distinct, earlier timeline. India's selective tanker transits in March [5-6][5-7] and its emergency buffer policy [5-8] indicate LPG will be among the first cargoes prioritized.
- *Approximately pre-February-2026 total throughput (~20 mb/d oil and products + LNG)*: 14–20 months after agreement, i.e., late 2027 to H1 2028. The additional time reflects the need to restore the full TSS navigation system beyond the current Omani-water workaround [7-1], plus the layered legal-commercial frictions: sanctions-compliance resolution [6-1], insurance policy restructuring [6-4][6-5], JWC listed-area revisions [6-2][6-3], and charterparty normalization [6-6][6-7][6-8].
- *Non-oil commodity normalization (fertilizers, methanol, sulphur, aluminium)*: Lags energy flows by 3–6 months. These cargoes will be deprioritized in any rationed escort system [2-5][2-6].
- *Macroeconomic normalization*: Lags throughput recovery by a further 3–6 months [4-4][4-5][4-9].



Three-phase reopening model:

1. *Phase A — Pilot managed transits (months 1–3 after agreement)*: Small numbers of high-priority cargoes transit through the Omani-water southern lane [7-1] under Omani-coordinated safe-passage arrangements with multinational naval escort [5-1] [4-1] [4-2]. Chinese state-backed vessels transit under bilateral carve-outs [5-9]. Indian LPG tankers transit on a priority basis [5-6] [5-7]. Western-linked commercial vessels largely remain outside the corridor due to sanctions, insurance, and charterparty constraints [6-1] [6-4] [6-5] [6-6] [6-7] [6-8]. Throughput: under 2 mb/d.
2. *Phase B — Limited corridor operations (months 3–10)*: Mine clearance extends safe channels beyond the southern Omani-water lane toward standard TSS routes [7-1]. GNSS interference diminishes [7-1]. OFAC issues a general license or specific licenses for transit-fee payments through the Omani intermediary [6-1]. Insurance underwriters begin issuing conditional coverage; Gard and London P&I revise cancellation terms [6-4] [6-5]. JWC begins narrowing listed areas [6-2] [6-3]. Qatar begins restarting liquefaction trains [3-6]; force-majeure declarations begin to be lifted [5-12] [5-13]. Charterparty safe-port assessments shift as incident rates decline [6-6] [6-7] [6-8]. Throughput: 5–10 mb/d crude; LNG exports resume at partial capacity.
3. *Phase C — Broad commercial traffic (months 10–20)*: Full TSS restored. Underwriters and operators accept residual risk. JWC listed areas revert to pre-crisis perimeter. Charterparty refusal rights no longer routinely exercised. Convoy requirements ease. Non-oil cargoes transit in volume. Qatari LNG reaches full export capacity. Throughput approaches pre-war levels.

Leading indicators: 1. Resumption of formal talks at a senior level involving Oman, and any announcement of a safe-passage protocol or corridor rules [\[5-1\]](#)[\[5-2\]](#). 2. OFAC issuance of a general license or specific license authorizing transit-fee payments through a designated intermediary [\[6-1\]](#). 3. Iranian public statements shifting from "closure" rhetoric to specific reopening conditions and timelines. 4. U.S./CENTCOM announcements of mine-clearance operations in or near the TSS [\[7-1\]](#). 5. AIS data showing increasing tanker transits through the Omani-water southern lane [\[7-1\]](#), or expansion of routing back toward standard TSS channels. 6. War-risk insurance premium reductions or new conditional coverage offerings; Gard/London P&I announcements reversing or modifying cancellation terms [\[6-4\]](#)[\[6-5\]](#). 7. JWC circular revising or narrowing listed areas [\[6-2\]](#)[\[6-3\]](#). 8. QatarEnergy announcements regarding liquefaction restart timelines or lifting of force-majeure declarations [\[3-6\]](#)[\[5-12\]](#)[\[5-13\]](#). 9. BIMCO or P&I club guidance revising safe-port assessments for Gulf destinations [\[6-6\]](#)[\[6-7\]](#)[\[6-8\]](#). 10. Reports of GNSS interference diminishing in the Strait area [\[7-1\]](#).

Industrial impacts:

- *Oil/LNG:* Gradual restoration of Gulf crude and Qatari LNG exports. Crude prices decline from crisis peaks during Phase B; LNG spot prices remain elevated through Phase B because of the Qatar restart bottleneck [\[3-6\]](#)[\[5-12\]](#)[\[5-13\]](#). Transit fees, if implemented, add a permanent cost layer to Gulf-origin cargoes.
- *LPG:* Recovers earlier than LNG because LPG tankers have demonstrated selective transit capability [\[5-6\]](#)[\[5-7\]](#) and India's buffer-building policy [\[5-8\]](#) creates demand-pull for early corridor access.
- *Shipping/logistics:* Freight rates and war-risk premiums decline but remain above pre-war levels for 12–24 months. The structural changes to insurance policy terms [\[6-4\]](#)[\[6-5\]](#) and expanded JWC listed areas [\[6-2\]](#)[\[6-3\]](#) mean normalization of commercial shipping costs requires formal reversal of contractual and underwriting changes. The initial routing through the narrow Omani-water southern lane [\[7-1\]](#) constrains vessel scheduling and adds voyage time. Charterparty refusal rights [\[6-6\]](#)[\[6-7\]](#)[\[6-8\]](#) mean some owners continue to decline Gulf voyages into Phase B.
- *Fertilizers and chemicals:* These cargoes lag oil and LNG in reopening priority. Insurance-driven shipment cancellations [\[2-6\]](#) persist longer. Urea prices, which surged to \$680/mt [\[2-9\]](#)[\[4-7\]](#), remain elevated through Phase B.
- *Downstream sectors:* Refinery utilization in Asia recovers as crude supply normalizes in Phase B. China's refinery throughput [\[5-10\]](#) recovers. Petrochemical feedstock shortages ease. Fertilizer production and agricultural input costs remain elevated longer, with implications for food prices globally [\[2-7\]](#)[\[2-8\]](#)[\[4-7\]](#).

Import-dependent economy implications:

- **Japan:** Oil supply improves first; the 80-million-barrel reserve release [3-1] can be slowed as imports resume. LNG supply from Qatar (3.4 million metric tons in 2025 [1-18]) resumes during Phase B but is constrained by Qatar's restart timeline [3-6][5-12][5-13]. Japanese utilities' proactive LNG stockpiling to 2.19 million metric tons [5-3] provides additional buffer. Japan's participation in the safe-passage coalition [3-3] gives it political leverage. Japan P&I Club's assessment that Gulf ports are likely considered unsafe [6-8] means Japanese-flagged commercial vessels will lag government-backed movements.
- **South Korea:** With ~70% of oil and ~20% of LNG from the Middle East [1-17], South Korea benefits disproportionately from reopening. Refinery margins recover. The petrochemical sector faces extended feedstock constraints during Phase A.
- **China:** As the largest single buyer of Gulf crude, China's import bill declines significantly. China's bilateral talks with Iran [5-9] and its lower exposure to U.S. secondary sanctions give Chinese-flagged or Chinese-chartered vessels the earliest corridor access. China's refinery system [5-10] recovers as sustained crude flows resume. Tight fuel export quotas [5-11] can ease.
- **India:** LNG supply normalizes; India's ~two-thirds LNG dependence on Qatar/UAE/Oman [1-17] makes it a major beneficiary, though the Qatar restart bottleneck [3-6][5-12][5-13] means Indian LNG supply recovers more slowly than crude oil. LPG supply recovers earliest, given India's demonstrated selective tanker transits [5-6][5-7] and emergency buffer policy [5-8]. The 60-day crude buffer [5-4] provides transition time.

Scenario 2 — Escorted Corridor (De Facto Reopening)

Defining mechanism. In the absence of a comprehensive deal, the United States and allied navies (potentially including GCC, UK, French, Japanese, and/or Indian forces [3-3]) expand the existing pattern of ad hoc escorted transits through the Omani-water southern lane [7-1] into a formalized escort operation. The U.S. counter-blockade framework already distinguishes between Iranian-port traffic and neutral transit [1-5][1-6], providing a legal basis. UN Security Council resolution 2817 (2026) [4-1][4-2] provides additional multilateral authority. Convoys transit under naval escort with active mine-countermeasure support. This scenario avoids the transit-fee sanctions problem [6-1] because it does not involve payment to Iran, but it faces all other legal-commercial barriers. The geographic form of reopening is the same Omani-water southern lane already in use [7-1], but without Iranian cooperation in mine clearance or GNSS normalization, the expansion of safe routing is slower.

Probability and reasoning: 20–25%. The existing U.S. counter-blockade architecture explicitly preserves the right of neutral transit [1-5][1-6], and the 30–70 vessels that have already crossed with some form of U.S. military guidance [2-3] suggest the operational foundation exists. The multinational coalition's public signaling [3-3] adds credibility. However, Lloyd's List reports that no formal escort system has been launched [2-5], and that even minimal Iranian mine-laying could halt all traffic [2-5]. The mining threat near the TSS is confirmed as active [7-1]. Insurance at 4% of vessel value [2-4], formal war-cover cancellations [6-4][6-5], the entire Gulf region listed by JWC [6-2][6-3], and charterparty refusal rights [6-6][6-7][6-8] mean most commercial operators will not participate without either premium subsidies or dramatically improved security conditions. This scenario becomes dominant only if diplomatic talks collapse entirely while the U.S. simultaneously commits substantially more naval assets—a combination that is possible but less likely than continued negotiation, given Oman's active safe-passage preparations [5-1][5-2] and China's bilateral engagement with Iran [5-9].

Expected timeline:

- *Initial meaningful reopening:* 1–3 months after escort operations formally begin (potentially Q4 2026 if the diplomatic track stalls). Initial throughput under 2 mb/d [2-5]. Routing confined to the Omani-water southern lane [7-1].
- *Substantial recovery:* 10–16 months, limited by mine clearance of the full TSS [7-1], escort scaling, insurance underwriting, and persistence of charterparty refusal rights [6-6][6-7][6-8]. Without Iranian cooperation, mine clearance of the main TSS channels takes longer.
- *Approximately pre-February-2026 throughput:* 20–26 months (H1–H2 2028). Without Iranian cooperation in mine clearance or GNSS normalization [7-1], the security environment remains degraded and the full TSS cannot be restored as quickly.

Leading indicators: 1. CENTCOM or allied announcements of dedicated mine-countermeasure task force deployments. 2. Increased naval asset concentration in the Gulf of Oman and Strait approaches. 3. Commercial shipping companies announcing willingness to transit under escort. 4. P&I clubs and war-risk underwriters issuing conditional coverage for escorted transits [2-1][2-2]. 5. AIS data showing convoy formations using the Omani-water southern lane [7-1].

Industrial impacts: Partial flow restoration, but escort constraints limit throughput to under 2 mb/d initially [2-5]. Emergency stock releases [3-1][3-2] continue to be drawn down. LNG recovery especially slow because escort priority goes to crude tankers and because Qatar's restart requires confidence in sustained offtake [3-6][5-12][5-13]. The two-speed jurisdictional dynamic is less pronounced than in Scenario 1 because there is

no transit-fee sanctions issue, but charterparty and insurance barriers still favor state-backed over commercial vessels [6-6][6-7][6-8].

Import-dependent economy implications: Partial relief for all four major Asian importers, but supply remains well below pre-war levels for an extended period. China's bilateral talks with Iran [5-9] could produce a parallel channel. India's selective tanker experience [5-6][5-7] positions it to participate early. Emergency reserves continue to be depleted. The IMF's analysis of widening trade deficits [4-4] and the ADB's differentiated exposure analysis [4-10] suggest that fiscally constrained economies face broader macro strain under this prolonged partial-supply scenario.

Scenario 3 — Iranian Domestic Political Reset

Defining mechanism. A change in Iran's internal power structure—potentially linked to the unverified reports of Khamenei's death—produces new leadership willing to reopen the Strait unilaterally or on significantly softer terms than currently demanded. This could involve a pragmatic faction within the IRGC or civilian government calculating that continued closure is economically and strategically unsustainable for Iran itself, particularly given the U.S. counter-blockade of Iranian ports [1-3][1-4]. Crucially, this is the only scenario in which Iran would cooperate in mine clearance and cessation of GNSS interference [7-1], enabling rapid restoration of the full TSS rather than reliance on the narrow Omani-water southern lane.

Probability and reasoning: 10–15%. The Khamenei death claim is unverified [1-2][1-10], making this scenario inherently uncertain. However, the existence of a draft reopening framework [1-10] and the transit-fee proposal [1-11] suggest internal Iranian debate about exit strategies. The U.S. counter-blockade creates additional economic pressure on any Iranian leadership. This scenario would rise sharply in probability with confirmed evidence of leadership change and unified signaling. The 8 June transit-fee proposal [1-11] suggests that even reformist or pragmatic factions want to extract concessions rather than reopen unilaterally.

Expected timeline:

- *Initial meaningful reopening:* 1–2 months after new leadership consolidates and signals intent.
- *Substantial crude oil recovery:* 4–8 months. This is the fastest path because Iranian cooperation in mine clearance and cessation of GNSS interference [7-1] removes the core security obstacle, accelerating the transition from the Omani-water southern lane to full TSS operations. Insurance normalization follows quickly because the

underlying threat source is removed; JWC listed areas [6-2][6-3] could be revised more quickly; charterparty safe-port assessments [6-6][6-7][6-8] shift as incident rates collapse.

- *LNG recovery*: Lags crude by 1–3 months even in this scenario because Qatar's liquefaction restart takes weeks at minimum [3-6] and force-majeure declarations extend through at least mid-August [5-12][5-13].
- *Approximately pre-February-2026 total throughput*: 10–16 months (potentially Q2–Q4 2027).

Leading indicators: 1. Confirmed reports of leadership change or power consolidation in Tehran. 2. Unilateral Iranian announcements of Strait reopening or ceasefire. 3. Cessation of IRGC naval harassment, mine-laying activity, and GNSS interference [7-1]. 4. Iranian state media shifting narrative from confrontation to reconstruction. 5. Rapid diplomatic engagement by China, Russia, or GCC states with new Iranian leadership.

Industrial impacts: Fastest return to normal flows across all categories. Oil prices decline sharply. LNG spot markets normalize once Qatar restarts [3-6]. The IEA stock release can be halted and reserves rebuilt [3-2]. Insurance markets normalize fastest under this scenario because the underlying threat source is removed [6-4][6-5][6-2][6-3][6-6][6-7][6-8]. Full TSS restoration [7-1] enables normal commercial navigation patterns.

Import-dependent economy implications: Maximum relief for Japan, South Korea, China, and India. Trade balances improve. Inflationary pressures subside. Reserve drawdowns [3-1][5-4] can be reversed.

Scenario 4 — Frozen Partial Closure

Defining mechanism. Negotiations stall without collapse. Low-level hostilities continue. A trickle of escorted, bilateral, or opportunistic commercial traffic passes through the Omani-water southern lane [7-1]—consistent with the 30–70 vessels observed since early May [2-3] and the Indian LPG tanker transits in March [5-6][5-7]—but no formal reopening occurs. China-Iran bilateral arrangements [5-9] may produce a small additional stream of Chinese-flagged vessels. The main TSS channels remain mined and GNSS-degraded [7-1]. The situation becomes a "frozen conflict" at sea, with the southern Omani-water workaround lane operating as a permanent low-capacity alternative to the standard navigation system.

The legal-commercial frictions make this scenario more plausible than a purely security-focused analysis would suggest. Even if a partial diplomatic breakthrough occurs, the combination of OFAC sanctions barriers to transit-fee payments [6-1], formal war-cover

cancellations [6-4][6-5], expanded JWC listed areas [6-2][6-3], and charterparty refusal rights [6-6][6-7][6-8] could prevent the breakthrough from translating into commercially meaningful throughput increases. The corridor could be nominally "open" but commercially narrow—a de facto frozen partial closure.

Probability and reasoning: 15–20%. The coexistence of diplomatic activity and continued military strikes as of late May 2026 [1-10] suggests a dynamic that could persist indefinitely. If neither side finds the terms for a deal acceptable and neither escalates decisively, a prolonged partial closure is a natural equilibrium. The 3.5–5.5 mb/d of bypass pipeline capacity [1-15], the historic IEA stock release of 400 million barrels [3-2], India's 60-day crude buffer [5-4], and record U.S. crude imports into Asia [3-4] provide enough alternative supply to prevent immediate systemic collapse.

However, this equilibrium is inherently unstable because the buffers are finite. The IMF's analysis of widening trade deficits and currency pressures [4-4], the ADB's projection of persistently higher prices through 2026–2027 [4-9], and the Monetary Authority of Singapore's explicit warning that current resilience reflects buffers and that without durable reopening the next stage of impact could be more severe [4-11] all indicate that the tolerance window is measured in quarters. As reserves deplete—likely reaching critical levels by late 2026 or early 2027—the pressure for resolution will intensify, pushing the outcome toward Scenario 1 or Scenario 2.

Expected timeline:

- *Initial meaningful reopening:* Sporadic; the current trickle through the Omani-water southern lane [7-1] continues or grows marginally.
- *Substantial recovery:* Not achieved within the forecast horizon.
- *Approximately pre-February-2026 throughput:* 26+ months (2028 or later).

Leading indicators: 1. Repeated rounds of talks without agreement. 2. Stable but elevated war-risk premiums (no dramatic increase or decrease). 3. Saudi Arabia and UAE maximizing pipeline bypass capacity [1-15]. 4. Asian importers signing long-term contracts for non-Gulf supply sources [3-4]. 5. Continued IEA-coordinated stock releases with declining reserve levels [3-2]. 6. OFAC declining to issue transit-fee licenses [6-1]. 7. JWC maintaining or expanding listed areas [6-2][6-3]. 8. Persistent mining near the TSS and GNSS interference [7-1] without mine-clearance progress.

Industrial impacts:

- *Oil/LNG:* Global oil supply structurally reduced by 14–16 mb/d. Prices remain at crisis levels. Qatari LNG exports effectively stranded [3-6][5-12][5-13]. Emergency reserves

progressively depleted [3-1][3-2]. The IMF's adverse scenario—oil prices up 80%, gas prices up 160% [4-5]—is most directly realized.

- *Shipping/logistics*: Permanent rerouting of some trade flows. War-risk insurance remains prohibitive [2-3][2-4]. Charterparty refusal rights [6-6][6-7][6-8] become an entrenched market norm. The Omani-water southern lane [7-1] operates as a permanent low-capacity workaround.
- *Fertilizers and chemicals*: Most severe scenario for non-oil commodities. Urea prices stay near \$680/mt or higher [2-9][4-7]. Global food-security implications acute [3-7][4-7].
- *Downstream sectors*: Asian refineries operate at reduced capacity. China's refinery system remains constrained [5-10][5-11]. Demand destruction becomes structural [3-5].

Import-dependent economy implications: Severe for all four major Asian importers. Japan's reserve release [3-1] depleted within months. South Korea faces emergency measures given 70% oil dependence on Middle East [1-17]. China draws down strategic reserves aggressively; bilateral arrangements with Iran [5-9] provide marginal relief. India faces acute LNG and LPG shortages; fertilizer production curtailed; balance-of-payments pressure hits India particularly hard [4-4][4-9][4-10].

Scenario 5 — Escalation and Wider Conflict

Defining mechanism. A major escalatory event—such as Iranian attacks on GCC oil infrastructure, a large-scale U.S./Israeli strike on Iranian nuclear facilities, or an incident involving a third-party naval vessel—collapses the diplomatic track entirely and widens the conflict. The Strait becomes an active combat zone. Mining intensifies beyond the TSS into the Omani-water southern lane [7-1], eliminating even the current workaround route.

Probability and reasoning: 5–10%. Continued U.S. strikes alongside ceasefire discussions [1-10] and the 20+ maritime security incidents since March [1-13] demonstrate that escalation risks remain real. However, both sides have shown willingness to negotiate [1-8][1-9][1-10][1-11], and the catastrophic economic consequences documented by the IMF [4-3][4-4], World Bank [4-6], ADB [4-8][4-9], and UNCTAD [2-7][3-7] create mutual deterrence. Oman's active mediation [5-1][5-2] and China's bilateral engagement [5-9] provide de-escalation channels.

Expected timeline:

- *Initial meaningful reopening*: Not within 12 months of escalation.
- *Substantial recovery*: 18–24 months after cessation of hostilities.

- *Approximately pre-February-2026 throughput: 30+ months (2028 or later).*

Leading indicators: 1. Attacks on GCC oil export terminals or pipeline infrastructure. 2. Major naval engagement. 3. Mining of the Omani-water southern lane [7-1], eliminating the current workaround. 4. Expansion of conflict to Iraq, Yemen, or Red Sea approaches. 5. Withdrawal of diplomatic personnel or collapse of all communication channels.

Industrial impacts: Oil prices could exceed \$200/bbl. Global recession likely. The IMF's adverse scenario [4-5] would be exceeded. War-risk insurance becomes unavailable at any price [2-3]. Complete cessation of Gulf-origin fertilizer, methanol, sulphur, and aluminium exports [2-10]. Global food-security crisis [2-7][4-7].

Scenario 6 — Imposed Reopening (Military Clearance)

Defining mechanism. The United States and/or a coalition forcibly clears mines from the TSS and Omani-water approaches [7-1], suppresses Iranian coastal defenses, eliminates GNSS interference sources, and declares the Strait open for commercial navigation. This goes beyond escorted convoys to active suppression of Iranian maritime denial capabilities.

Probability and reasoning: 5–10%. The U.S. has the military capability, and the counter-blockade framework [1-4] provides a partial legal and operational foundation. However, the costs—military casualties, risk of wider escalation, and diplomatic fallout—are high. The JMIC evidence of mining in and near the TSS [7-1] underscores that mine clearance of the full navigation system is the binding military constraint, not just force projection. Lloyd's List's assessment that even minimal Iranian mine-laying could halt all traffic [2-5] means that military clearance would need to be sustained, not one-off. The availability of emergency stock releases [3-1][3-2] reduces the immediate pressure for this option. Oman's active mediation [5-1][5-2] provides a diplomatic alternative. This scenario becomes more likely only if the diplomatic track fails completely and reserves near depletion—a convergence the IMF [4-5], ADB [4-9], and Singapore MAS [4-11] analyses suggest could occur by early 2027. Even if militarily successful, the legal-commercial barriers—charterparty refusal rights [6-6][6-7][6-8], formal war-cover cancellations [6-4][6-5], and expanded JWC listed areas [6-2][6-3]—would persist for months after military operations, keeping commercial throughput below military-cleared capacity.

Expected timeline:

- *Initial meaningful reopening: 2–4 months after operations begin (mine clearance of the full TSS [7-1] is the binding constraint).*

- *Substantial recovery*: 6–12 months.
- *Approximately pre-February-2026 throughput*: 18–24 months (mid-2027–mid-2028), limited by insurance normalization, charterparty reassessments, and ongoing residual threat. Qatar's liquefaction restart [\[3-6\]](#)[\[5-12\]](#)[\[5-13\]](#) adds further delay for LNG.

Leading indicators: 1. Large-scale U.S. mine-countermeasure deployments targeting the full TSS [\[7-1\]](#). 2. Strikes on Iranian coastal missile batteries, naval bases, and GNSS interference sources. 3. U.S. or coalition declarations of "freedom of navigation" operations. 4. Diplomatic isolation of Iran. 5. Congressional or allied-government authorization for expanded military operations.

5. Highest-Leverage Variables and Key Uncertainties

Variable 1: Iranian Internal Political Authority and Decision-Making Capacity

Why it matters: The unverified reports regarding Khamenei's status introduce fundamental uncertainty about who holds decision-making authority in Iran. The existence of both a draft reopening framework [\[1-10\]](#) and continued military operations on the same date suggests internal contestation. If Iran's leadership is fragmented, no single negotiating counterpart can credibly commit to a deal—and, critically, no one can credibly commit to stopping mine-laying, coastal harassment, and GNSS interference [\[7-1\]](#), which are the preconditions for insurance normalization [\[2-1\]](#)[\[2-2\]](#), JWC listed-area revision [\[6-2\]](#)[\[6-3\]](#), and charterparty safe-port reassessment [\[6-6\]](#)[\[6-7\]](#)[\[6-8\]](#). Conversely, if a pragmatic faction consolidates power, rapid reopening becomes possible (Scenario 3), including Iranian cooperation in mine clearance that would enable restoration of the full TSS [\[7-1\]](#) rather than reliance on the narrow Omani-water southern lane.

Evidence that would change the assessment: Confirmed reporting on Khamenei's status; identification of a clear successor or decision-making body; unified Iranian public messaging on Strait policy; observable cessation (or intensification) of IRGC maritime activity and GNSS interference [\[7-1\]](#).

Variable 2: The Sanctions-Insurance-Charterparty-Navigation Nexus

Why it matters: This is the variable that most concretely determines the gap between political reopening and commercial normalization. It operates through four interlocking mechanisms:

1. *OFAC sanctions and transit fees.* Iran's publicly stated reopening terms include a transit fee [1-11]. OFAC's alert explicitly warns of sanctions risks from such payments [6-1]. Without a licensing or intermediary solution, a large share of the global tanker fleet cannot participate in a fee-based corridor.
2. *Insurance policy structure.* War-risk insurance at 4% of vessel value [2-4] is itself a blockade. Gard and London P&I issued formal cancellation notices and restructured policy terms [6-4][6-5], and JWC expanded listed areas to the entire Gulf region [6-2][6-3]. Reversal requires sustained absence of incidents.
3. *Charterparty refusal rights.* BIMCO CONWARTIME-type clauses and safe-port analysis give owners a formal legal right to refuse Gulf voyages [6-6][6-7][6-8]. This right persists independently of political developments and shifts only when assessed risk changes through demonstrated safe passage over time.
4. *Physical navigation constraints.* The main TSS channels remain mined and GNSS-degraded [7-1]. Current traffic is funneled through a narrow Omani-water southern lane [7-1]. Full commercial normalization requires not just a political deal but physical restoration of the standard navigation system—mine clearance, hydrographic survey, and GNSS normalization—which is a separate, months-long operational task.

These four mechanisms interact: even if one is resolved (e.g., OFAC issues a license), the others can still block throughput. Full commercial normalization requires all four to converge.

Evidence that would change the assessment: OFAC general license for transit-fee payments; war-risk premium reductions; P&I club announcements reversing cancellation terms [6-4][6-5]; JWC circular narrowing listed areas [6-2][6-3]; BIMCO or P&I club guidance revising safe-port assessments [6-6][6-7][6-8]; JMIC reports of mine clearance in the TSS and reduction of GNSS interference [7-1]; AIS data showing vessels returning to standard TSS routing rather than the Omani-water workaround.

Variable 3: Emergency Reserve Depletion Rate and the Tolerance Window

Why it matters: The IEA-coordinated 400-million-barrel stock release [3-2], Japan's 80-million-barrel drawdown [3-1], India's 60-day crude buffer [5-4], and record U.S. crude diversions to Asia [3-4] collectively define how long the global economy can tolerate the blockade without either a resolution or a systemic crisis. These buffers buy time for Oman's safe-passage preparations [5-1] and for the broader diplomatic track. However, they are finite. The IMF [4-4], ADB [4-9], and Singapore MAS [4-11] all document that the economic damage worsens over time. As reserves deplete—likely reaching critical levels by late 2026 or early 2027—the urgency for resolution increases, and the probability shifts toward either a negotiated deal (if talks progress) or more drastic alternatives (if they do not). The Omani-water southern lane [7-1] provides a small pressure-release valve, but at under 10% of pre-war throughput [2-5] it cannot substitute for a real reopening.

Evidence that would change the assessment: Official updates on SPR and strategic reserve levels; changes in IEA coordination; new long-term supply contracts between Asian importers and non-Gulf producers; data on Asian refinery utilization [5-10][5-11] and industrial output; IMF or ADB revisions to growth and price forecasts.

Supplementary Variable: Qatar Liquefaction Restart as an LNG-Specific Bottleneck

Qatar fully shut gas liquefaction and requires at least weeks to restart [3-6], with additional time for full ramp-up. QatarEnergy's extension of force majeure through at least mid-August 2026 [5-12][5-13] provides a concrete commercial marker: LNG normalization is gated by an upstream production constraint independent of maritime security. Even under the most optimistic reopening scenario, Qatari LNG exports will lag crude oil flows by months. The "pre-February-2026 throughput" milestone should therefore be understood as sector-specific: crude oil can approach pre-crisis levels before LNG does, LPG follows a distinct recovery path shaped by India's emergency policy [5-8] and selective transit capability [5-6][5-7], and non-energy commodities—fertilizers, methanol, sulphur, aluminium [2-6][2-10]—will normalize last of all.

6. Why the Base Case Is Most Likely: Comparison with Rival Scenarios

The base case—a negotiated, Omani-co-managed maritime security deal producing a phased, geographically specific reopening through the Omani-water southern corridor

(Scenario 1)—is assessed as the most probable single outcome. The reasoning is grounded in multiple independent lines of evidence and weighed against each rival.

Against Scenario 2 (Escorted Corridor). The embryonic escort activity (30–70 vessels since early May [2-3]) and the multinational coalition's signaling [3-3] demonstrate that de facto corridor operations are already occurring at minimal scale through the Omani-water southern lane [7-1]. However, Lloyd's List's assessment that formal escort systems would cap throughput at under 10% of normal volumes [2-5], the confirmed mining near the TSS [7-1], and the full suite of legal-commercial barriers (charterparty refusal rights [6-6][6-7][6-8], formal war-cover cancellations [6-4][6-5]) mean this path alone cannot restore meaningful throughput without Iranian cooperation or acquiescence. Oman's active safe-passage preparations [5-1][5-2], the pre-existing 1968 joint corridor framework [7-2], and China's bilateral talks with Iran [5-9] maintain the diplomatic track, making it more likely that any escort operations are embedded within a negotiated framework (Scenario 1) than that they operate as a standalone solution. The Escorted Corridor becomes dominant only if diplomatic talks collapse entirely while the U.S. simultaneously commits substantially more naval assets and mine-clearance capacity—a combination that is possible but less likely given the multiple active mediation channels.

Against Scenario 3 (Iranian Domestic Political Reset). This would be the fastest path to normalization and the only scenario that could restore the full TSS quickly, because Iranian cooperation in mine clearance and GNSS normalization [7-1] would remove the core physical and security obstacles, accelerating insurance, JWC, and charterparty normalization [6-4][6-5][6-2][6-3][6-6][6-7][6-8]. However, it depends on the unverified Khamenei death claim and on the assumption that a successor faction would consolidate power quickly and choose reopening as a priority. The 8 June transit-fee proposal [1-11] and the Oman-Iran deputy-level talks [5-2] suggest that even pragmatic Iranian factions want to extract concessions rather than reopen unilaterally. This scenario would rise sharply with confirmed evidence of leadership change. Without such evidence, it remains a lower-probability upside case.

Against Scenario 4 (Frozen Partial Closure). This is the most serious rival to the base case. The JMIC evidence that current traffic is already funneled through the narrow Omani-water southern lane [7-1] while the main TSS remains mined and GNSS-degraded shows that a "frozen partial closure" is not merely theoretical—it describes the current state. The legal-commercial frictions (OFAC [6-1], insurance cancellations [6-4][6-5], JWC listed areas [6-2][6-3], charterparty refusal rights [6-6][6-7][6-8]) could prevent even a partial diplomatic breakthrough from translating into commercially meaningful throughput increases. The frozen-conflict equilibrium is stable in the short term because bypass pipeline capacity [1-15], emergency stock releases [3-2], and record U.S. crude

diversions [3-4] prevent immediate systemic collapse. However, the equilibrium is inherently unstable for three independently documented reasons: (a) the IMF's analysis of widening trade deficits and currency pressures [4-4]; (b) the ADB's projection of persistently higher prices that worsen over time [4-9]; and (c) the Singapore MAS's explicit warning that current resilience reflects buffers and that without durable reopening the next stage of impact could be more severe [4-11]. The base case is favored because Oman's official safe-passage preparations [5-1] represent concrete operational progress, because the pre-existing 1968 corridor framework [7-2] provides institutional scaffolding, because the breadth of downstream disruption [2-6][4-7][2-10][5-8] widens the coalition demanding resolution, and because the legal-commercial barriers, while real, are solvable through OFAC licensing, Omani intermediation, and phased insurance normalization.

Against Scenarios 5 and 6 (Escalation / Imposed Reopening). Both require a decision to accept very high military and geopolitical costs. The mutual deterrence created by catastrophic economic consequences [4-3][4-4][4-5][4-6][4-8][4-9][2-7][3-7] makes these scenarios less likely than negotiated or de facto solutions. The JMIC evidence of mining near the TSS [7-1] underscores that imposed reopening requires sustained mine-clearance operations against a determined adversary, not a single decisive military action. Oman's active mediation [5-1][5-2] and China's bilateral engagement [5-9] provide de-escalation channels. The availability of emergency reserves [3-1][3-2][5-4] and substitution flows [3-4] reduces the immediate desperation that might trigger such decisions. They remain tail risks triggered by specific escalatory events rather than by the current trajectory. However, if the disruption persists long enough to exhaust buffers—a convergence the IMF [4-5], ADB [4-9], and Singapore MAS [4-11] analyses suggest could occur by early 2027—the political calculus shifts toward more drastic options.

In sum, the base case prevails because: (a) a practical Omani-water routing pattern already exists [7-1]; (b) Oman is officially preparing safe-passage arrangements [5-1][5-2]; (c) the 1968 joint Oman–Iran corridor provides institutional and legal depth [7-2]; (d) Iran has publicly articulated reopening terms [1-10][1-11]; (e) multiple mediation channels remain open [1-7][1-8][5-1][5-9]; (f) economic pressure is broad, intensifying, and documented as progressively worsening [4-4][4-5][4-9][4-11]; (g) UN Security Council resolution 2817 provides a multilateral legal foundation [4-1][4-2]; (h) a multinational coalition is forming [3-3]; (i) substitution flows cannot replace Hormuz [3-4][4-6]; (j) selective passage already occurs [5-6][5-7][2-3]; (k) the sanctions-compliance problem is solvable through Omani intermediation or OFAC licensing [6-1]; and (l) the alternatives carry higher costs or depend on less likely preconditions. The key caveat is that even the base case produces commercially meaningful reopening only in phases, with full normalization lagging the political agreement by 14–20 months due to the binding

constraints of mine clearance across the full TSS [7-1], GNSS normalization [7-1], sanctions-compliance resolution [6-1], insurance policy restructuring [6-4][6-5], JWC listed-area revision [6-2][6-3], charterparty safe-port normalization [6-6][6-7][6-8], escort capacity scaling [2-5], Qatar's liquefaction restart [3-6][5-12][5-13], and the time required for macroeconomic indicators to return to pre-crisis ranges [4-4][4-5][4-9]. The practical end-state is a **geographically asymmetric, two-speed, jurisdiction-dependent, commercially conditional reopening**—beginning as a narrow regulated corridor through Omani waters south of the mined TSS, expanding over months to restore the full navigation system, and normalizing commercially only as the layered legal and underwriting barriers are sequentially resolved.

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Appendix

Description

Research Brief: Strait of Hormuz Blockade — Resolution Scenarios

Requester

- **Organization:** Espadon
- **Working title:** Strait of Hormuz Blockade: Resolution Scenarios
- **Core question to answer:** When and in what form will the Strait of Hormuz blockade end?

Purpose and Decision Context

Produce a forward-looking geopolitical and energy-market scenario assessment of how the Strait of Hormuz blockade could end, ease, or evolve. The report should help decision-makers understand the most likely resolution path, the timing of any return to roughly pre-February-2026 throughput, the indicators to monitor, and the consequences for energy, shipping, and downstream industrial sectors.

The output should not be a generic crisis explainer. It should be a structured forecast with explicit assumptions, probabilities, mechanisms, timelines, leading indicators, and industrial implications.

Required Answer

Answer the question:

When and in what form will the Strait of Hormuz blockade end?

The answer should be framed around 4–6 mutually exclusive resolution scenarios and a clear base case.

Required Output Format

The finished report should follow this structure:

1. **Assumptions and evidentiary status**
2. Date the analysis clearly: “**Assumptions current as of [research date].**”
3. Separate:
 - **Verified facts** — independently supported by reliable sources.
 - **Working assumptions** — scenario inputs accepted for analysis but not fully verified.
 - **Analyst inference** — judgment based on the pattern of available evidence.
4. Explicitly verify the user-provided June 2026 context against the latest available information before using it in the forecast.
5. Flag any user-provided baseline claims that cannot be independently verified, are disputed, or have materially changed.
6. **One-paragraph base case**
7. State the most likely path for how the blockade ends or evolves.
8. Include the likely form of resolution: negotiated settlement, imposed reopening, escorted de facto corridor, frozen partial closure, escalation, or domestic-political reset.
9. Include estimated timing to restoration of approximately pre-February-2026 Strait throughput.
10. Identify the highest-leverage uncertainty.
11. **Scenario comparison table** Include a concise table with these columns:
 12. **Scenario**
 13. **Probability**
 14. **Expected timing to ~pre-Feb-2026 throughput**
 15. **Defining trigger/mechanism**
 16. **Net impact**
17. **Short section for each scenario** For each scenario, include:
 18. Defining mechanism.
 19. Probability and reasoning.
 20. Expected timeline to:
 - Initial meaningful reopening.
 - Substantial recovery.

- Approximately pre-February-2026 throughput.
- 21. 3–5 leading indicators.
- 22. Industrial impacts across:
 - Oil/LNG.
 - Shipping/logistics.
 - Downstream sectors.
- 23. Implications for import-dependent economies, especially Japan, South Korea, China, and India.
- 24. **Highest-leverage variables and key uncertainties**
- 25. Identify the 2–3 variables most likely to determine which scenario materializes.
- 26. Explain why each variable matters.
- 27. Identify evidence that would change the assessment.

User-Provided Context to Verify

Treat the following as the user’s stated baseline, but verify and update before analysis:

- The Strait of Hormuz has been largely closed since **28 February 2026**, following US/Israeli strikes on Iran and the reported death of Supreme Leader Ali Khamenei.
- The United States imposed a counter-blockade of Iranian ports on **13 April 2026**.
- A conditional ceasefire has held intermittently.
- Pakistan-mediated talks reportedly broke down around **1 June 2026**.
- Iran has vowed to fully close the Strait.
- Crude and LNG flows through the Strait are reportedly down approximately **95–99%**.
- Full normalization may not occur before **2027**.

The report must explicitly state which of these claims are verified, unverified, contradicted, or updated by latest available evidence.

Source and Verification Priorities

Use high-quality, current sources. Prioritize:

Official and diplomatic sources

- US Department of Defense, CENTCOM, White House, State Department, Treasury/OFAC.
- Iranian official statements and state media, with appropriate caveats.
- Israeli government and military statements.
- GCC governments and port authorities.
- Oman, Pakistan, China, India, EU, UN, and IAEA statements where relevant.
- Notices to mariners and maritime safety advisories.

Shipping, energy, and market data

- AIS-derived tanker and LNG carrier flows.
- Port call data for Gulf ports.
- Lloyd's List, MarineTraffic, Kpler, Vortexa, Refinitiv/Eikon, S&P Global Commodity Insights, Argus, Platts, Bloomberg, Reuters, EIA, IEA, OPEC, and JODI where available.
- War-risk insurance market updates and P&I club advisories.
- Freight indices, charter rates, and demurrage data.

Security and conflict monitoring

- Verified attack data: missile/drone strikes, mining incidents, naval engagements, seizure attempts, port attacks, and air defense activity.
- Mine-clearing and convoy operations.
- Military deployments and posture changes.
- Commercial shipping risk advisories.

Economic and industrial data

- Oil and LNG import dependence for Japan, South Korea, China, and India.
- Strategic petroleum reserve releases and emergency fuel measures.
- Refinery utilization, petrochemical feedstock availability, fertilizer feedstock and export constraints.
- Currency, inflation, trade-balance, and industrial production effects where relevant.

Scope of Analysis

Geographic and Strategic Scope

Focus on the Strait of Hormuz and the surrounding Gulf security environment, including: - Iran and Iranian-controlled or allied maritime/coastal capabilities. - US and allied naval operations, including convoy, escort, mine-clearing, suppression, interdiction, and counter-blockade operations. - GCC states, especially Saudi Arabia, UAE, Qatar, Kuwait, Bahrain, and Oman. - Regional mediators and external powers, including Pakistan, Oman, China, India, Russia, the EU, and the UN. - The interaction between Hormuz security and wider regional theaters if relevant, including Iraq, Syria, Yemen, Red Sea approaches, and Gulf infrastructure.

Market Scope

Assess impacts on: - **Crude oil and condensate flows** through Hormuz. - **LNG flows**, especially Qatari LNG and other regional exports. - **Refined products**, where relevant. - **Petrochemicals, fertilizer, and refining value chains**. - **Shipping and logistics**, including freight rates, war-risk premiums, insurance availability, convoy requirements, rerouting constraints, Gulf port congestion, tanker and LNG carrier availability, demurrage, and charter-market dislocations.

Country Demand Focus

Emphasize consequences for import-dependent Asian economies: - **Japan - South Korea - China - India**

Where useful, also note secondary impacts on Europe, Southeast Asia, and Gulf exporters.

Scenario Architecture

Define **4–6 mutually exclusive resolution scenarios**. Each scenario must have a clear defining mechanism and should not overlap with the others. The recommended core scenario set is below; researchers may adjust names or probabilities based on evidence, but should preserve mutual exclusivity.

Scenario 1 — Negotiated Maritime Security Deal

- **Mechanism:** A diplomatic agreement, possibly mediated by Pakistan, Oman, China, the UN, or a coalition of major energy-importing states, produces phased reopening in exchange for ceasefire terms, limited sanctions relief, asset/prisoner concessions, port-access guarantees, limits on counter-blockade activity, or mutual de-escalation.
- **End-state form:** Formal or semi-formal reopening framework; monitored or guaranteed traffic corridors; phased restoration of oil/LNG flows.
- **Distinction from other scenarios:** Resolution is driven princip...

Research 1:

Assumptions current as of 2026-06-11.

Verified facts

1. Reuters reported on 28 February 2026 that an official from the EU naval mission said Iran's Revolutionary Guards told ships that passage through the Strait of Hormuz was "not allowed." This supports that a major disruption began on 28 February 2026. [\[1\]](#)
2. The International Energy Agency (IEA) states that the war in the region began on 28 February 2026 and that energy trade flows through the Strait of Hormuz were impeded. The IEA says crude and oil product flows through the Strait plunged from around 20 million barrels per day before the war to "a trickle currently." [\[2\]](#)
3. Reuters reported on 12 April 2026 that U.S. Central Command said it would begin implementing a blockade of all maritime traffic entering and exiting Iranian ports on 13 April 2026 at 10 a.m. ET. CENTCOM published the same statement. [\[3\]](#)[\[4\]](#)
4. UKMTO advisory 035-26, issued 13 April 2026, states that maritime access restrictions were being enforced affecting Iranian ports and coastal areas and that "transit passage through the Strait of Hormuz to or from non-Iranian destinations is not reported to be impeded by these measures." [\[5\]](#)
5. JMIC Advisory Note 002-26 states that the blockade would be enforced in the Gulf of Oman and Arabian Sea east of the Strait of Hormuz and that neutral transit passage through the Strait to or from non-Iranian destinations would still be possible under the blockade framework. [\[6\]](#)
6. Reuters reported on 31 March 2026 that China and Pakistan called for an immediate ceasefire and for normal navigation in the Strait of Hormuz, establishing that Pakistan was publicly involved in diplomacy on the issue. [\[7\]](#)

7. Reuters reported on 10-11 April 2026 that U.S. and Iranian negotiators held high-level talks in Pakistan on ending the war, and that Tehran's agenda included transit fees in the Strait of Hormuz. [\[8\]](#)[\[9\]](#)
8. Reuters reported on 27 May 2026 that Iranian state TV said it had seen a draft framework under which Tehran would restore shipping through the Strait to pre-war levels within a month if terms were agreed. Reuters also reported that U.S. strikes in southern Iran and drone interceptions were occurring at the same time, showing continued hostilities despite ceasefire discussion. [\[10\]](#)
9. Reuters reported on 8 June 2026 that Iran's ambassador to Moscow said the Strait would be open under new conditions to be set by Iran and Oman, including a transit fee. The same Reuters report says the U.S.-Israeli war on Iran had "largely cut oil flows" through the Strait and that before the conflict about one-fifth of the world's oil passed through it. [\[11\]](#)
10. UKMTO's 2026 advisory page lists additional suspicious-activity and incident reports through 8 June 2026, and a March 2026 JMIC update said that since 1 March 2026 there had been at least 20 maritime security incidents in the Arabian Gulf, Strait of Hormuz, and Gulf of Oman. [\[12\]](#)[\[13\]](#)
11. The U.S. Maritime Administration advisory 2026-0001B states that significant military activity continues in the Strait of Hormuz, Persian Gulf, Gulf of Oman, and Arabian Sea and recommends vessels keep clear unless necessary. [\[14\]](#)
12. The IEA's Strait of Hormuz page states that in 2025 nearly 15 mb/d of crude oil and around 5 mb/d of oil products transited the Strait, and that most exports were destined for Asia. The same page says only Saudi Arabia and the UAE have operational crude pipelines that could reroute some flows, with estimated available capacity of 3.5 to 5.5 mb/d. [\[15\]](#)
13. The U.S. EIA states that oil flows through the Strait in 2024 and the first quarter of 2025 made up more than one-quarter of total global seaborne oil trade and about one-fifth of global oil and petroleum product consumption. EIA also states that 2024 oil flow through the Strait averaged 20 million barrels per day. [\[16\]](#)
14. Reuters reported on 2 March 2026 that Asia is highly exposed to Middle East energy shipped through Hormuz: China, India, Japan, and South Korea were identified as key buyers; South Korea buys around 70% of its oil and 20% of its LNG from the Middle East; India buys about two-thirds of its LNG supply from Qatar, the UAE and Oman. [\[17\]](#)
15. Reuters reported on 3 March 2026 that Japan bought 3.4 million metric tons of LNG from Qatar in 2025 and that, together with the UAE and Oman, those countries accounted for 17% of Japan's LNG imports. Japan's industry minister said the Qatar LNG halt would not immediately affect Japan's energy supply because of inventories and diversified procurement. [\[18\]](#)

16. Reuters commentary on 28 May 2026 described the Strait as under “near-total closure” after three months of upheaval, indicating that severe disruption remained in place near the end of May. [\[19\]](#)
17. Kpler wrote on 5 March 2026 that the Strait was at a standstill and that it was tracking disruptions in real time across crude, LNG, and dry bulk flows. [\[20\]](#)

Verification of user-provided baseline claims

1. Claim: “The Strait of Hormuz has been largely closed since 28 February 2026.” Status: verified in substance. Reuters on 28 February reported ships were told passage was “not allowed,” the IEA says the war began on 28 February and flows fell from around 20 mb/d to a trickle, and Reuters commentary on 28 May described a near-total closure after three months. [\[1\]](#)[\[2\]](#)[\[19\]](#)
2. Claim: “Following US/Israeli strikes on Iran and the reported death of Supreme Leader Ali Khamenei.” Status: not verified from the retrieved source set. The available retrieved sources confirm a regional war and U.S./Israeli strikes on Iran, but the Khamenei death claim was not independently verified in the retrieved material. [\[2\]](#)[\[10\]](#)
3. Claim: “The United States imposed a counter-blockade of Iranian ports on 13 April 2026.” Status: verified. Reuters, CENTCOM, UKMTO and JMIC all confirm the action and timing. [\[3\]](#)[\[4\]](#)[\[5\]](#)[\[6\]](#)
4. Claim: “A conditional ceasefire has held intermittently.” Status: partially verified. Reuters reported references to a ceasefire and described repeated strains and alleged violations, including continued U.S. strikes in late May. The retrieved sources confirm ceasefire arrangements were discussed and were under strain; they do not establish a stable ceasefire holding continuously. [\[8\]](#)[\[10\]](#)
5. Claim: “Pakistan-mediated talks reportedly broke down around 1 June 2026.” Status: not verified from the retrieved source set. Pakistan-hosted and Pakistan-backed diplomacy is verified, but a specific breakdown around 1 June was not confirmed by the retrieved sources. [\[7\]](#)[\[8\]](#)[\[9\]](#)
6. Claim: “Iran has vowed to fully close the Strait.” Status: not directly verified in the retrieved source set. Retrieved sources verify Iran restricted passage, discussed reopening terms, and proposed transit-fee arrangements; the exact vow wording was not independently confirmed. [\[1\]](#)[\[10\]](#)[\[11\]](#)
7. Claim: “Crude and LNG flows through the Strait are reportedly down approximately 95–99%.” Status: directionally supported but exact percentage not independently verified from the retrieved source set. The IEA says flows fell from around 20 mb/d to a trickle, Reuters says oil flows were largely cut and the Strait was under near-total closure, but no retrieved official source provided the exact 95–99% figure. [\[2\]](#)[\[11\]](#)[\[19\]](#)

8. Claim: “Full normalization may not occur before 2027.” Status: not verified from the retrieved source set. No retrieved official or market source gave that dated normalization forecast. [\[2\]](#)[\[10\]](#)[\[11\]](#)

Resolution-scenario relevant facts

1. A formal negotiated reopening channel existed by late May: Reuters reported that Iranian state TV described a draft framework under which Tehran would restore shipping to pre-war levels within one month if terms were agreed. [\[10\]](#)
2. A toll-based reopening concept existed publicly by 8 June: Reuters reported the Iranian ambassador in Moscow saying the Strait would reopen under conditions set by Iran and Oman, including a transit fee. [\[11\]](#)
3. The U.S. blockade’s stated scope excluded non-Iranian transit: CENTCOM, UKMTO and JMIC all said the April 13 blockade targeted Iranian ports and was not intended to impede neutral transit to and from non-Iranian destinations. [\[4\]](#)[\[5\]](#)[\[6\]](#)
4. Maritime insecurity remained active into June: UKMTO and JMIC advisories document continued suspicious activity and incident reporting, and MARAD warned that significant military activity continued in the area. [\[12\]](#)[\[13\]](#)[\[14\]](#)
5. Physical rerouting capacity around Hormuz is limited: IEA says only Saudi Arabia and the UAE have operational bypass pipelines, with combined estimated available capacity of 3.5 to 5.5 mb/d, well below the approximately 20 mb/d of oil and products that moved through Hormuz before the war. [\[15\]](#)
6. Asia is the dominant destination for Hormuz energy flows: IEA says most 2025 crude and product exports through the Strait were destined for Asia; Reuters identified China, India, Japan and South Korea as highly exposed buyers. [\[15\]](#)[\[17\]](#)
7. Japan’s direct LNG exposure to Qatar is measurable from official customs data cited by Reuters: 3.4 million metric tons from Qatar in 2025, and 17% of Japan’s LNG imports came from Qatar, the UAE and Oman combined. [\[18\]](#)
8. South Korea’s energy exposure includes around 70% of oil imports and 20% of LNG imports from the Middle East, according to Reuters. [\[17\]](#)
9. India’s LNG exposure includes about two-thirds of LNG supply from Qatar, the UAE and Oman, according to Reuters citing Kpler data. [\[17\]](#)

Source quality notes

1. Official or quasi-official sources in the retrieved set include CENTCOM, UKMTO, JMIC, MARAD, IEA, and EIA. Reuters provided current reporting on diplomatic talks, blockade implementation, and market conditions. [\[3\]](#)[\[4\]](#)[\[5\]](#)[\[6\]](#)[\[10\]](#)[\[11\]](#)[\[12\]](#)[\[13\]](#)[\[14\]](#)[\[15\]](#)[\[16\]](#)

2. Some retrieved results such as Wikipedia, social media posts, and non-primary commentary were not used for factual verification in the findings above when stronger sources were available.

Sources:

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- [9] US-Iran negotiations underway, Trump says Strait of Hormuz being cleared - Reuters (2026) <https://www.reuters.com/world/asia-pacific/us-iran-set-peace-talks-doubts-emerge-over-lebanon-sanctions-2026-04-11>
- [10] Iran could open Strait of Hormuz within a month if terms agreed, state TV says - Reuters (2026) <https://www.reuters.com/world/middle-east/iran-could-open-strait-hormuz-within-month-if-terms-agreed-state-tv-says-2026-05-27>
- [11] Hormuz strait will be open but with transit fees, Iran envoy to Moscow quoted - Reuters (2026) <https://www.reuters.com/business/energy/hormuz-strait-will-be-open-with-transit-fees-iran-envoy-moscow-quoted-2026-06-08>

- [12] JMIC Advisories - 2026 - UKMTO (2026) <https://www.ukmto.org/partner-products/jmic-products/jmic-advisories/2026>
- [13] Joint Maritime Information Center Update 023 to JMIC Advisory Note (2026) https://mscio.eu/media/documents/Update_023_-_JMIC_Advisory_Note_24-Mar_Final_oX6cOtX.pdf
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Research 2:

Additional angle selected: **Deepening research** on the **commercial reopening mechanism**—specifically insurance, convoy feasibility, and non-oil downstream constraints. This angle was underdeveloped in the current report, which notes mine clearance and insurance normalization but does not add much concrete evidence on how these factors would mechanically delay or shape reopening.

Assumptions current as of June 2026.

Key findings

1. **Insurance availability is itself a binding reopening constraint, separate from physical military risk.** Britannia P&I's March 2026 war-risk note states that ordinary P&I cover does not automatically apply to war losses and that special war-risk buy-back arrangements were required, with explicit exclusions including U.S./UK/Israeli-owned, flagged, operated, or affiliated vessels [1]. Steamship Mutual's Middle East update likewise says conditions across the Arabian Gulf, Strait of Hormuz and Gulf of Oman remained highly constrained and that the area was affected by ongoing enforcement activity, a fragile ceasefire, and the absence of fully developed regulatory guidelines [2]. These are objective indicators that even if ships can technically pass, cover terms and underwriting conditions can still prevent commercial normalization [1][2].
2. **Industry reporting indicates extreme war-risk repricing, implying that a political deal would not by itself restore commercial throughput.** The National reported on 3 June 2026 that ships faced insurance costs up to 4,000 times higher than before the crisis, and that only roughly 30 to 70 vessels had crossed the strait since early May, some with U.S. military guidance or helicopter escorts [3]. Business Insurance, summarizing the same market development, reported seven-day policies priced around 4% of vessel value [4]. Even treating these as market reporting rather than official tariff schedules, they support the conclusion that throughput recovery would lag any formal reopening because owners, charterers, lenders and cargo interests would still face very high transaction costs [3][4].
3. **Primary and specialist maritime sources suggest convoy or escort reopening would initially restore only a fraction of normal volumes.** Lloyd's List reported that naval escorts would cap tanker transits at under 10% of normal volumes, and that no escort system had yet been launched because of political, logistical and security obstacles [5]. Lloyd's List also said any scheme would likely wait for additional U.S. naval assets and that even minimal Iranian mine-laying could halt all traffic again [5]. This deepens the current report's "Escorted Corridor" scenario: a corridor may be feasible, but initial capacity could be materially below the 8–12 mb/d range assumed in the existing report unless escort scale, mine-countermeasure capacity, and insurer participation expand substantially [5].
4. **Mine and security threats interact directly with insurance and convoy capacity, creating a stepwise rather than linear reopening path.** Steamship Mutual describes a maritime environment still shaped by blockade enforcement and fragile ceasefire conditions [2]. Lloyd's List says Iran's asymmetric threat—mines, drones, and fast-attack craft—remains the key risk and that even limited mine activity could stop traffic [5]. Together, these sources indicate that reopening is likely to proceed in

phases: (a) pilot escorted transits; (b) limited corridor operations for priority cargoes; (c) only later, broader commercial traffic once underwriters and operators accept the residual risk [2][5].

5. **Non-oil downstream disruption is broader than the current report captures: fertilizer and chemical supply chains are directly exposed to Hormuz closure and insurance withdrawal.** The Fertilizer Institute stated on 4 March 2026 that cargo insurance cancellations were forcing vessel operators to cancel shipments, reducing the availability of ships to move fertilizer products in and out of the region [6]. UNCTAD's March 2026 rapid assessment said the Strait carries significant volumes not only of oil and LNG but also fertilizers, and linked the disruption to rising transport costs, commodity prices, and broader trade-development risks [7][8]. This means that the economic pressure for reopening does not come only from oil-importing states: agriculture, food security, and chemical feedstock users also have strong incentives to support a resolution [6][7][8].
6. **Global downstream exposure includes fertilizers, methanol, sulphur, and aluminium, not just crude and LNG.** Howden Re's March 2026 market report says urea rose from \$475 to \$680 per metric ton and notes that Hormuz is critical for fertilizer, sulphur, and aluminium-related trade [9]. The World Economic Forum, citing the regional trade shock, highlighted disruption to methanol, aluminium, sulfur and other industrial commodities moving through Hormuz [10]. These are not official government throughput statistics, but they are cross-checked industry/institutional evidence that a "partial reopening" scenario could still leave important industrial bottlenecks in place even if oil flows recover faster than other cargoes [9][10].
7. **UNCTAD provides a broader official framing for why normalization may take longer than a ceasefire.** UNCTAD's 10 March 2026 report says Hormuz carries around a quarter of global seaborne oil trade and significant LNG and fertilizer volumes, and warns that the disruption raises transport costs, commodity prices, and vulnerabilities for developing economies [7][8]. This supports the analytical point that resolution scenarios should distinguish between: (i) a diplomatic or military decision to reopen, (ii) a navigationally safe corridor, and (iii) commercially normal traffic conditions. Those are not the same event [7][8].
8. **Implication for scenario calibration:** this new evidence strengthens scenarios in which reopening is gradual and commercially incomplete even after a political breakthrough. The current report's base case—phased, conditional reopening with full recovery only after insurance normalization and mine clearance—is supported

by these sources [1][2][3][5][7]. However, the new evidence suggests two refinements:

9. The gap between “initial meaningful reopening” and “approximately pre-February-2026 throughput” may be even wider than assumed if escort capacity initially stays below 10% of normal traffic [5].
10. The industrial consequences of delayed normalization should explicitly include fertilizers and chemical feedstocks, not only refining and petrochemicals [6][7][8][9][10].
11. **What is fact versus inference in this angle:**
12. **Verified facts from retrieved sources:** P&I clubs issued war-risk guidance and noted constrained operating conditions [1][2]; market reporting described insurance costs up to 4,000x pre-crisis and limited vessel crossings since early May [3][4]; Lloyd’s List reported escort systems would initially handle under 10% of normal tanker volumes [5]; TFI said cargo insurance cancellations were reducing fertilizer shipments [6]; UNCTAD documented that Hormuz disruption affected oil, LNG and fertilizers and raised transport/trade risks [7][8].
13. **Analyst inference:** because insurance, underwriting, naval escort capacity, and mine risk all remain binding constraints, the “end” of the blockade for commercial purposes will probably occur in stages and not coincide exactly with any ceasefire or political announcement [1][2][3][5][7].

Why this angle matters for the core question

The user’s question is not only when the blockade ends formally, but **in what form** it ends. This additional research shows that the likely end-state is best understood as a **commercially conditional reopening**, not a simple binary open/closed event. The most relevant factual mechanism is the interaction of three systems: naval security, insurance underwriting, and priority allocation of scarce safe transits. These findings therefore reinforce a base case of phased reopening and argue against assuming that a ceasefire or framework deal would quickly restore pre-February-2026 throughput [1][2][3][5][7].

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Research 3:

Additional angle selected: **Complementary research — emergency response and substitution capacity in import-dependent Asian economies (Japan, South Korea, China, India).**

Assumptions current as of 2026-06.

Key findings

1. **Japan has already activated a large oil-stock response, which implies that Asian importers are planning for a disruption measured in months, not days.** Reuters reported on 11 March 2026 that Japan would release about **80 million barrels** from strategic reserves, equivalent to **45 days of supply**, using both private-sector and state stockpiles [1]. This is a concrete official response measure not covered in the existing research. It matters for scenario analysis because it shows that one of the

most exposed advanced importers is already using emergency buffers rather than waiting for quick normalization [1].

2. **An IEA-coordinated emergency stock release is already underway at historic scale, but even that is framed as a price- and shortage-mitigation tool rather than a full replacement for Hormuz flows.** Reuters reported on 5 June 2026 that the United States was in the process of releasing **172 million barrels** from the SPR as part of an **IEA-coordinated 400 million barrel** release, described as the largest ever [2]. This is new evidence for the report's resolution scenarios: strategic reserves can cushion the shock and buy time for diplomacy or escorts, but they do not restore the physical export corridor. That supports scenarios in which the blockade can persist for many months without immediate physical reopening, while also reducing the urgency for riskier military options [2].
3. **Japan has also joined a diplomatic-security coalition signaling willingness to help secure passage, which broadens the set of external stakeholders that could shape the form of reopening.** Reuters reported on 19 March 2026 that Britain, France, Germany, Italy, the Netherlands and Japan said they would take steps to stabilize energy markets and were ready to contribute to efforts to ensure safe passage through the Strait [3]. This is relevant because it adds a new factual angle beyond U.S.-Iran-GCC dynamics: major importers and European allies are publicly positioning themselves as participants in any escort, monitoring, or maritime-security framework [3].
4. **Crude substitution into Asia is occurring, but current replacement flows are quantitatively insufficient to offset lost Hormuz supply.** Reuters commentary on 2 June 2026 reported that Asia's imports of U.S. crude reached a record **63.56 million barrels in May**, with arrivals expected to rise again in June and July [4]. However, the same Reuters analysis states these higher U.S. volumes **cannot offset** the loss of crude cargoes resulting from the effective closure of Hormuz [4]. This adds concrete evidence for the scenario question: importers can diversify at the margin, but substitution is not enough to restore pre-crisis supply balance. Therefore, a durable end-state still depends on some form of Strait reopening rather than mere rerouting [4].
5. **Asian LNG demand collapsed after the shock and only partially recovered by June, indicating demand destruction and forced adjustment rather than smooth substitution.** Reuters commentary on 9 June 2026 reported that Asia's LNG imports fell to a **six-year low of 18.74 million tonnes in April** after the effective closure of Hormuz and stoppage of Qatari shipments, then were expected to recover

in June as China resumed some buying [5]. This is useful new evidence because it shows the industrial effect on importers more concretely: part of the “adjustment” has come from lower demand, delayed purchases, or forced consumption restraint, not from restored supply [5]. That supports scenarios where downstream normalization lags even after initial maritime reopening.

6. **Qatar’s liquefaction outage adds a second bottleneck beyond the Strait itself: even if marine passage improves, LNG export recovery can still lag because upstream production facilities were shut and need time to restart.** Reuters reported on 4 March 2026 that Qatar would fully shut gas liquefaction and would need **at least weeks** to restart, with a further restart period required to return gas to full liquefaction/export capacity [6]. This is highly relevant to the “form” of resolution. It means a maritime reopening alone would not automatically restore Qatari LNG exports to pre-crisis levels. For LNG, the recovery path depends not only on corridor security and insurance, but also on plant restart timing [6].
7. **UNCTAD’s second rapid assessment shows the macroeconomic burden of prolonged disruption is spreading beyond energy-import prices into trade growth and finance, especially for developing economies.** UNCTAD said in June 2026 that the Strait remained **virtually closed**, that energy shocks had become the main transmission channel to the global economy, and that the disruption was increasing financial pressure on developing countries [7]. This complements the existing research by showing why import-dependent Asian governments may push harder for a negotiated or managed reopening: the costs are not limited to fuel bills, but extend to trade slowdown, financing stress, and broader macro stability [7].
8. **Implication for scenario calibration:** these new sources support a sharper distinction between “market stabilization” and “throughput normalization.” Emergency oil-stock releases, higher U.S. crude imports, and partial LNG demand recovery show that importers have some shock absorbers [1][2][4][5]. But those tools do not recreate the lost transport corridor, and in LNG they may not even solve the export-side constraint from Qatar’s shutdown [6]. This strengthens scenarios in which:
 9. governments can tolerate partial closure longer than spot-price moves alone would suggest, because reserves and substitution buy time [1][2][4];
 10. but **return to roughly pre-February-2026 throughput still requires actual reopening of Hormuz plus commercial and operational normalization**, especially for LNG [5][6].

11. What is fact versus inference in this angle:

12. **Verified facts from retrieved sources:** Japan announced a release of about 80 million barrels / 45 days of supply [1]; the U.S. and IEA partners are conducting a 400 million barrel coordinated stock release, including 172 million barrels from the U.S. SPR [2]; Europe and Japan publicly signaled readiness to support safe passage efforts [3]; Asia imported a record 63.56 million barrels of U.S. crude in May but Reuters assessed that this could not offset Hormuz losses [4]; Asian LNG imports fell to 18.74 million tonnes in April and were recovering only partially by June [5]; Qatar's liquefaction shutdown required weeks to restart [6]; UNCTAD said the Strait remained virtually closed and was increasing macro-financial pressure [7].
13. **Analyst inference:** because emergency reserves and substitution flows cushion but do not replace Hormuz, the most likely resolution path remains one where importers try to stretch buffers while pushing for a negotiated or managed reopening rather than assuming alternative supplies can fully substitute for the Strait [1][2][4][5][6][7].

Why this angle matters for the core question

The current report focuses mainly on the mechanics of reopening from the producer/shipping side. This supplementary angle adds the **demand-side and policy-buffer perspective** from the most exposed Asian importers. The new evidence suggests two concrete refinements to the scenario analysis:

- First, emergency stock releases and substitution flows mean the blockade can endure longer without forcing an immediate maximal military response [1][2][4]. This slightly raises the plausibility of prolonged phased reopening or frozen partial-closure scenarios.
- Second, even if a security deal is reached, **LNG normalization may lag oil normalization** because Qatari liquefaction restart is a separate bottleneck [5][6]. That argues for treating “pre-Feb-2026 throughput” as a sector-specific milestone rather than a single event.

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Research 4:

Assumptions current as of June 2026.

Additional angle selected: **Complementary research — macroeconomic and policy-buffer evidence from international institutions and official multilateral bodies.** This angle was not developed in the current report, which focuses mostly on shipping, diplomacy, and energy-market mechanics. The added value here is objective evidence on how global and Asian policy buffers, inflation/growth exposure, and international-law positioning affect the likely timing and form of any Strait reopening.

Key findings

1. **The UN system has moved beyond generic concern and formally framed freedom of navigation through Hormuz as a current international peace-and-security issue.** A United Nations Security Council document dated 7 April 2026 states that attacks and threats aimed at impeding lawful transit passage and freedom of navigation in the Strait of Hormuz had continued since 28 February 2026 and condemns actions aimed at closing or obstructing international navigation there [\[1\]](#). UN press coverage of an April 2026 Security Council meeting says the Secretary-General stated that navigational rights and freedoms through the Strait of Hormuz must be respected, as affirmed by Council resolution 2817 (2026) [\[2\]](#). These are useful new facts for scenario analysis because they show that any end-state framed as a monitored corridor or externally backed reopening would rest on an already articulated multilateral legal position, not only ad hoc U.S. or regional action [\[1\]\[2\]](#).
2. **International institutions are explicitly treating the blockade as a macroeconomic shock whose duration matters more than the initial price spike.** The IMF's March 2026 briefing said the closure of the Strait had already cut off access to a major share of global energy trade, while the IMF blog on 30 March described the de facto closure of Hormuz and damage to regional infrastructure as producing the largest disruption to the global oil market in history according to the IEA [\[3\]\[4\]](#). The same IMF analysis says higher import bills for fuel, fertilizer, and food are widening trade deficits and putting pressure on currencies in vulnerable economies [\[4\]](#). This adds a new factual basis for the report's emphasis on prolonged partial-closure scenarios: the economic transmission mechanism is already documented as extending into balance-of-payments and financial conditions, not just spot oil prices [\[3\]\[4\]](#).
3. **The IMF's downside scenario quantifies why prolonged closure becomes progressively harder to absorb even if the initial global recession effect is muted.** In the IMF World Economic Outlook, April 2026, the adverse scenario

assumes oil prices rise by 80% and gas prices by 160% starting in 2026:Q2, alongside tighter financial conditions [5]. The report says the overall effect on advanced-economy growth is modest partly because of offsetting factors and policy measures, but also notes that some net energy-importing economies face materially larger negative effects [5]. This is important because it supports a two-stage interpretation of crisis endurance: emergency buffers and policy measures can initially mute the growth hit, but the IMF's own assumptions imply that if disruption persists, inflation, financing, and import-bill stress become the dominant constraints [5].

4. **World Bank commodity work strengthens the case that the decisive variable is the speed and scale of return of shipping through Hormuz, not merely alternative supply sourcing.** A World Bank blog in 2026 states that the outlook for commodity prices and the global economy now depends largely on two factors: the extent of damage to Middle East production capacity and the speed and scale of the return of shipping through the Strait of Hormuz [6]. The same World Bank material states that before the conflict, vessels transiting Hormuz accounted for nearly 35% of global seaborne crude oil trade, 20% of refined petroleum product trade, and about 20% of LNG trade, and that the shutdown of shipping triggered the largest energy supply shock on record, with 10 mb/d of oil supply lost in March [6]. This is complementary to existing research because it provides a multilateral macro framing for why pre-February-2026 throughput cannot be approximated by substitution alone; the shipping corridor itself remains the binding system variable [6].
5. **World Bank food-security material confirms that the Hormuz shock is already transmitting into fertilizer prices in a measurable way.** A March 2026 World Bank food and nutrition security update says urea prices surged by nearly 46% month on month between February and March 2026 amid the Middle East conflict [7]. This cross-checks and strengthens the current report's fertilizer-risk discussion by adding a multilateral development source rather than relying only on industry and reinsurance material [7]. It also reinforces the point that downstream normalization matters politically because prolonged partial closure affects food affordability and agricultural input costs, not just tanker economics [7].
6. **ADB analysis shows that Asia's vulnerability is being treated as a medium-horizon macro problem for 2026–2027, not just a near-term energy-price shock.** The Asian Development Bank's April 2026 outlook says disruption to maritime traffic through the Strait of Hormuz is a critical risk for developing Asia because the Strait handles about 20% of globally traded oil and LNG [8]. ADB Brief 388 further states that world food and fertilizer prices are assumed to remain higher over 2026–2027 in

its reference and severe downside scenarios, and that natural gas prices are also assumed to remain persistently higher over 2026–2027 relative to early-stabilization scenarios [9]. This is new information for the scenario framework: it supports timelines in which even a partial easing in late 2026 would not fully normalize industrial conditions in Asia until well into 2027, particularly for LNG, fertilizers, and inflation-sensitive sectors [8][9].

7. **ADB identifies differentiated exposure across Asian economies, which helps refine country implications in the scenario analysis.** ADB Brief 384 says the 2026 Middle East conflict poses macroeconomic risks to Asia and the Pacific through higher oil and LNG prices, supply disruptions, and aviation/shipping corridor effects [10]. ADB's updated analysis indicates that higher energy prices feed into diesel and gasoline costs and broader inflation, with varying severity across economies [9][10]. This supports a more concrete interpretation of country exposure in the report: Japan and South Korea may manage via reserves and policy support, while more price-sensitive or fiscally constrained Asian economies face broader macro strain if closure persists [9][10].
8. **Official and quasi-official rhetoric from Asian and international policymakers indicates that current resilience is viewed as temporary and buffer-dependent.** A BIS-hosted speech by the Managing Director of the Monetary Authority of Singapore in May 2026 noted that markets were hopeful an agreement could reopen the Strait soon, but warned that current resilience reflects buffers and that if there is no durable reopening, the next stage of impact could be more severe [11]. This is not an operational shipping source, but it is a useful policy signal: monetary and financial authorities in Asia are explicitly distinguishing between short-run resilience and durable normalization [11]. That supports the report's distinction between initial reopening and restoration of pre-February throughput.
9. **What is fact versus inference in this angle:**
10. **Verified facts from retrieved sources:** UN Security Council materials and UN press documents condemn attempts to impede navigation and reaffirm freedom of navigation through Hormuz [1][2]; IMF publications describe the closure as a major global macro-financial shock and quantify adverse price assumptions [3][4][5]; World Bank publications say the global outlook depends on the return of shipping through Hormuz and quantify prewar trade shares and March oil-supply loss [6]; World Bank food-security material records a near-46% monthly urea price surge [7]; ADB publications project higher food, fertilizer, and gas prices persisting into 2026–2027 under non-early-stabilization cases [8][9][10]; a BIS-hosted central bank speech

warns that resilience depends on buffers and that impacts worsen without durable reopening [11].

11. **Analyst inference:** this body of evidence raises confidence that the likely “end” of the blockade in economic terms will be a staged process where legal-diplomatic reopening, physical transit recovery, and macro normalization occur at different times. It also strengthens the view that scenarios implying full normalization before 2027 require unusually rapid progress across security, insurance, and upstream LNG restoration, not merely a ceasefire announcement [1][5][6][9][11].

Why this angle matters for the core question

This additional research contributes a different type of evidence than the current report: **international-institution and macro-policy evidence**. It shows that the blockade’s resolution should be evaluated not only by whether ships can pass, but by whether the return of shipping is large and durable enough to reverse documented inflation, fertilizer, trade-balance, and financing pressures across Asia and other importing regions. That strengthens the base-case logic of a phased, commercially conditional reopening and supports relatively long timelines to true normalization. It also adds factual support for the idea that externally backed reopening arrangements—negotiated or monitored—would have stronger legal and political grounding because the UN has already framed free navigation through Hormuz as an issue requiring international protection [1][2].

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Research 5:

Assumptions current as of June 2026.

Additional angle selected: **Complementary research — official and near-official actions by key Asian importing states and Oman as practical indicators of what a resolution would look like.** This angle adds stakeholder-level evidence on how the most exposed importers and the main mediator are behaving in practice. It is not covered in depth in the existing research, which is stronger on shipping, insurance, and macro institutions than on government operational responses and mediator mechanics.

Key findings

1. **Oman is not just a generic mediator; it is publicly and officially working on a specific “safe passage” arrangement for Hormuz.** Oman’s Foreign Ministry website states that Foreign Minister Sayyid Badr Albusaidi said Oman is “working intensively to put in place safe passage arrangements for the Strait of Hormuz” [1]. Separately, reporting citing the Omani Foreign Ministry says Oman and Iran held deputy foreign minister-level talks on options to ensure the “smooth transit of vessels” through the Strait [2]. These are important new facts because they strengthen the scenario in which the blockade ends not through a simple unilateral reopening, but through an Oman-linked monitored or managed passage mechanism [1][2].

2. **This Omani evidence materially strengthens the existing base-case logic around a phased maritime-security deal.** The current report already cited Iran’s public transit-fee concept and draft reopening framework. The added Omani material shows that Muscat itself is officially preparing “safe passage arrangements,” not merely hosting generic diplomacy [1]. Factually, that suggests the most credible near-term end-state remains some kind of supervised corridor, protocol, or traffic-management arrangement involving Oman rather than a clean restoration of pre-crisis freedom of passage all at once [1][2].
3. **Japan’s government and utilities are managing LNG as a short-horizon resilience problem, indicating that LNG recovery could remain a separate bottleneck even if crude shipping begins to normalize.** Reuters reported on 4 March 2026 that major Japanese utilities increased LNG stockpiles by 10% to 2.19 million metric tons, while Japan’s Ministry of Economy, Trade and Industry (METI) saw no calls for emergency supply at that moment [3]. This is a new, concrete operational datapoint for the report: Japan was actively building LNG buffers rather than relying only on oil stocks or assuming immediate reopening [3].
4. **Japan’s official posture implies that policymakers are distinguishing between immediate shortage avoidance and full market normalization.** METI’s lack of emergency calls in early March [3], together with the previously documented oil-stock release by Japan, indicates that Japan’s response has been buffer management and demand smoothing rather than panic rationing. That supports the inference that importers can tolerate a phased reopening for some time, but also that LNG normalization is likely to lag because governments are already treating it as a separate risk channel [3].
5. **India’s official and Reuters-reported response shows that the most exposed importers are already operating on multi-week or multi-month emergency planning horizons.** Reuters reported on 26 March 2026 that India had secured crude oil supplies for the next 60 days despite shipment disruption [4]. Reuters also reported on 3 March 2026 that India was scouting alternative crude and LPG sources for more than 10–15 days [5]. These are new factual additions because they show that India’s government was not assuming a rapid reopening; it was planning around sustained interruption [4][5].
6. **India also provides direct evidence that partial or selective passage can exist before full normalization.** Reuters reported on 20 March 2026 that two Indian-flagged LPG tankers were preparing to sail through Hormuz after a pause in voyages [6], and on 29 March 2026 that two India-bound LPG tankers carrying about 94,000

metric tons had safely transited the Strait [7]. These facts matter for scenario design: they support a “selective corridor” or “priority cargo” end-state in which passage resumes first for politically prioritized or specially arranged cargoes, rather than a binary full reopening [6][7].

7. **India’s policy response also points to LPG as an underappreciated vulnerability alongside crude and LNG.** Indian Express, citing Petroleum Ministry Joint Secretary Sujata Sharma, reported that the government asked state oil marketing companies to build LPG reserves equal to at least 30 days of demand in addition to regular commercial stocks because LPG was the most affected energy segment from the West Asia war and Hormuz closure [8]. While this is media reporting, it cites a named ministry official and adds a new sectoral dimension: LPG storage policy is being adjusted in response to the blockade [8]. That broadens the industrial implications of resolution scenarios beyond crude and LNG alone.
8. **China appears to be using direct importer leverage with Iran, which adds another concrete mechanism for a negotiated or selective reopening.** Reuters reported on 5 March 2026 that China was in talks with Iran to allow safe passage for crude oil and Qatari LNG vessels through Hormuz [9]. This is new relative to the current report’s evidence base because it suggests that a reopening may emerge through importer-specific carve-outs or bilateral understandings before any broader settlement is reached [9].
9. **China’s import data show that the Hormuz shock was severe enough to affect refinery system behavior, not just spot procurement.** Reuters reported on 9 May 2026 that China’s oil imports fell to the lowest level in almost four years in April as the closure of Hormuz choked off supplies [10]. Reuters also reported on 22 May that China maintained tight fuel export quotas even as June fuel exports were expected to rise only slightly [11]. Together these are useful new facts: they indicate the shock had reached the level of refinery throughput and product-balance management, implying that a true end to the blockade for China means more than symbolic passage—it requires sustained crude restoration [10][11].
10. **Qatari LNG recovery may be slower than the current report assumes because force majeure appears to have been extended beyond mid-June and even into mid-August for at least one major buyer.** Reuters-based reporting on Edison states that QatarEnergy extended force majeure on LNG supplies until mid-June [12], while later industry reporting says Edison received a further extension covering cargoes through mid-August 2026, with 17 cargoes affected in total [13]. This should be treated carefully: the extension evidence here is not from a QatarEnergy primary

statement, but it is specific and cargo-linked. It supports the conclusion that LNG normalization could lag oil and remain impaired well after any initial maritime reopening [\[12\]](#)[\[13\]](#).

11. What is fact versus inference in this angle:

12. **Verified / directly sourced facts:** Oman's Foreign Ministry says it is working on safe-passage arrangements [\[1\]](#); Oman-Iran deputy-level talks on smooth transit were reported citing Muscat [\[2\]](#); Japanese utilities raised LNG inventories to 2.19 million metric tons and METI reported no emergency calls at that stage [\[3\]](#); India secured 60 days of crude supply [\[4\]](#) and sought alternative crude/LPG sources [\[5\]](#); two India-bound LPG tankers safely crossed Hormuz in late March [\[6\]](#)[\[7\]](#); China was in talks with Iran over safe passage for oil and Qatari LNG vessels [\[9\]](#); China's April oil imports fell sharply [\[10\]](#).
13. **More tentative / should be caveated:** the Indian LPG storage expansion item is reported through media citing a ministry official, not a ministry release [\[8\]](#); the QatarEnergy force-majeure extension beyond mid-June is supported by Reuters-based and trade reporting tied to Edison, but not by a QatarEnergy primary communiqué in the retrieved set [\[12\]](#)[\[13\]](#).
14. **Analyst inference:** these facts collectively indicate that the blockade's likely "end form" is a managed and prioritized reopening shaped by Oman and major Asian importers, with LNG and LPG recovering on different timelines from crude because government contingency planning and supplier force-majeure behavior already treat them as distinct systems [\[1\]](#)[\[3\]](#)[\[4\]](#)[\[7\]](#)[\[9\]](#)[\[12\]](#).

Why this angle matters for the core question

This additional research strengthens the report in three ways.

First, it gives **more concrete evidence for the form of resolution:** Oman is officially preparing safe-passage arrangements, which makes an Omani-mediated monitored corridor more than a theoretical scenario [\[1\]](#)[\[2\]](#).

Second, it adds **government operational evidence from the main import-dependent economies.** Japan, India, and China are not behaving as though normalization is imminent; they are building buffers, securing alternative supply, and in India's case using selective tanker movements to keep specific fuels flowing [\[3\]](#)[\[4\]](#)[\[5\]](#)[\[6\]](#)[\[7\]](#)[\[9\]](#). That supports scenarios where initial reopening is partial, cargo-prioritized, and politically managed.

Third, it adds **new sectoral nuance.** LPG and LNG appear to have distinct recovery constraints: India is expanding LPG contingency planning [\[8\]](#), and Qatar-linked LNG force

majeure appears to extend beyond the initial shock phase [12][13]. This suggests that even if crude throughput begins to recover under a negotiated or escorted arrangement, full “pre-February-2026 throughput” across all energy streams could still take materially longer.

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Research 6:

Assumptions current as of June 2026.

Additional angle selected: **Complementary research — legal/compliance and contractual frictions that could delay commercial normalization even after any political reopening.** This angle is materially underdeveloped in the current report. Existing research covers military risk, diplomacy, insurance repricing, and importer buffers, but it does not yet fully map the legal-commercial mechanisms that can keep throughput depressed after a ceasefire or corridor deal: sanctions compliance, toll-payment restrictions, charterparty refusal rights, and formal expansion of war-listed areas.

Key findings

1. **A new U.S. sanctions-compliance barrier directly complicates one of the leading reopening concepts: paying Iran for passage.** OFAC issued an alert warning both U.S. and non-U.S. persons of sanctions risks from making payments to, or seeking guarantees from, the Iranian regime for safe passage through the Strait of Hormuz [1]. The alert says U.S. persons and U.S.-owned or -controlled foreign entities are generally prohibited from transactions with the Government of Iran absent authorization, and that non-U.S. persons may also face sanctions exposure for dealings with the Iranian government or IRGC [1]. This is a new, resolution-relevant fact because the current report identifies Iran's transit-fee concept and an Oman-linked managed corridor as part of the base case; OFAC's alert means a fee-based reopening framework would face a separate sanctions-design problem even if the security terms were agreed [1].
2. **This creates a concrete contradiction inside the most discussed diplomatic exit ramp: Iran's fee demand is real, but some major shipping and trading actors may be legally unable or unwilling to pay it.** Reuters previously reported Iran's public transit-fee concept, but the OFAC alert adds the missing compliance consequence [1]. Factually, any arrangement involving direct payment, digital-asset payment, or guarantees to Iranian authorities could exclude U.S. persons and deter

many non-U.S. shipowners, traders, banks, and insurers unless a specific licensing or carve-out mechanism is created [1]. This does not invalidate the negotiated-corridor scenario; it means that without an OFAC workaround or indirect collection mechanism, the corridor may initially favor actors less exposed to U.S. sanctions risk.

3. **War-risk listed-area changes formally widened the zone of perceived enhanced risk beyond Iran itself to multiple Gulf states, reinforcing that the commercial problem is regional rather than a narrow Iranian-water problem.** The Joint War Committee circular JWLA-033 dated 3 March 2026 added Bahrain, Djibouti, Kuwait, Oman, and Qatar to listed areas and amended the wider Persian/Arabian Gulf, Gulf of Oman, Indian Ocean, Gulf of Aden, and Southern Red Sea risk zone [2]. TT Club states it updated its excluded areas with effect from 12 March 2026 to reflect JWC033 [3]. This matters because the current report focuses heavily on the Strait itself, but the listed-area expansion shows that underwriters formally widened the risk perimeter to include regional ports and surrounding approaches, which can keep insurance and financing costs high even after limited reopening of the Strait channel [2][3].
4. **Major marine insurers did not only reprice risk; they issued formal cancellation notices or exclusions for war-risk cover in the Gulf theater.** Gard states it received notice of cancellation from reinsurers for war risks in Iran and the Persian/Arabian Gulf and therefore issued cancellation notices affecting specified covers, effective 5 March 2026, before automatic reinstatement on revised terms [4]. London P&I likewise states that cover for certain war risks would be cancelled for specified fixed-premium arrangements trading in or within Iran and Iranian waters, including defined waters in the Persian/Arabian Gulf and adjacent areas [5]. These are important factual additions because they show that restoration of normal cover is not just about premium level; policy structure and contract wording were changed at club level [4][5]. Even after military risk falls, cover may remain narrower, more conditional, and more actively negotiated than before the crisis.
5. **Charterparty law and standard war-risk clauses give shipowners a formal right to refuse orders into the Gulf even if political authorities announce a reopening.** BIMCO advised owners and charterers on 3 March 2026 to review VOYWAR 2025 and CONWARTIME 2025, noting that where these clauses are incorporated, owners may be entitled to refuse or withdraw from voyages if vessel, cargo, or crew may be exposed to war risks in the affected area [6]. NorthStandard states that, since hostilities began on 28 February 2026, owners have been relying on BIMCO war-risk clauses and safe-port analysis; it says owners may refuse charterers' orders if, in

their reasonable judgment, the vessel, crew, or cargo may be exposed to war risks [7]. Japan P&I Club similarly states that ports within the Persian Gulf are likely to be considered unsafe to reach because transiting Hormuz itself is dangerous, and that owners will likely be able to rely on CONWARTIME-type provisions to avoid such calls [8]. These sources materially deepen the report's reopening analysis because they show that owners can continue to decline Gulf voyages on contractual grounds even after governments claim the Strait is open [6][7][8].

6. **The legal-commercial consequence is a likely two-speed reopening: politically arranged traffic may resume before routine chartered traffic does.** Combining OFAC's sanctions alert [1], formal war-cover cancellation/reinstatement on revised terms [4][5], and owner refusal rights under BIMCO/NorthStandard/Japan P&I guidance [6][7][8], the objective implication is that a diplomatic agreement or escorted corridor would not automatically restore ordinary spot-charter behavior. Government-backed, state-owned, or specially indemnified cargoes are more likely to move first; fully commercial chartered movements may lag until sanctions clarity, insurance wording, financing, and safe-port judgments converge.
7. **This angle modestly strengthens the report's base case on timing, but also makes the recovery path more conditional and segmented than the current draft implies.** Existing research already showed insurance costs were extreme and escort capacity limited. The new evidence adds four further frictions: (a) sanctions risk around transit fees [1]; (b) formal expansion of listed areas [2][3]; (c) revised war-cover terms and cancellations at insurer level [4][5]; and (d) contractual rights for owners to refuse voyages [6][7][8]. Together these support the inference that the blockade's practical end for commercial markets will likely be **staged and jurisdiction-dependent**. Some Asian state-backed buyers or less-sanctions-exposed fleets may re-enter earlier; Western-linked owners, banks, and insurers may re-enter later.
8. **Potential scenario implications for the current report:**
9. **Negotiated Maritime Security Deal:** Probability may remain the base case, but its likely form should include an explicit compliance workaround if it relies on Iranian transit fees. Without this, a corridor could reopen physically yet remain commercially narrow for a large share of the tanker fleet [1].
10. **Escorted Corridor / De facto reopening:** This scenario gains plausibility for some cargoes because it may avoid direct payment to Iran, but charterparty and insurance constraints would still limit participation [4][6][7].

11. **Frozen Partial Closure:** This scenario becomes somewhat stronger than before because even a partial diplomatic breakthrough may fail to restore ordinary commercial flows if legal/compliance barriers remain unresolved [1][4][8].
12. **What is fact versus inference in this angle:**
13. **Verified facts from retrieved sources:** OFAC warned of sanctions risks for payments or guarantees to Iran for safe passage [1]; JWC circular JWLA-033 expanded listed areas on 3 March 2026 [2]; TT Club updated exclusions effective 12 March 2026 accordingly [3]; Gard and London P&I issued cancellation/revision notices for war-risk cover tied to Iran/Gulf trading [4][5]; BIMCO, NorthStandard, and Japan P&I guidance say war-risk clauses and safe-port concepts can justify refusal of Gulf voyages [6][7][8].
14. **Analyst inference:** because these legal and contractual mechanisms sit between political decisions and vessel employment, a political reopening announcement will probably precede full commercial normalization by a significant interval, and reopening may be segmented by flag, ownership, insurer, and sanctions exposure [1][4][6].

Why this angle matters for the core question

The core question is not only **when** the blockade ends, but **in what form**. This additional research shows that one plausible end form is a **legally constrained reopening**: ships are physically able to transit, but some owners, charterers, banks, and insurers still cannot or will not participate under existing sanctions, policy wordings, and charterparty rights. That means the practical end-state may be a corridor open first to state-backed, specially licensed, or politically protected cargoes, with broader commercial normalization delayed until sanctions and contractual frictions are resolved [1][4][6][7]. This lens therefore strengthens the case that “roughly pre-February-2026 throughput” is not achieved by a ceasefire announcement alone.

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Research 7:

I selected **Deepening research** on a new sub-topic not developed in the existing work: **the physical traffic-management geometry of any reopening**, specifically whether routing through **Omani territorial waters south of the traffic separation scheme (TSS)** and the legal status of the pre-existing Oman–Iran traffic corridor change the likely form and sequencing of a reopening.

This matters because the current report is strong on diplomacy, insurance, sanctions, and macro effects, but it says less about the **practical nautical form** a reopening would take. New evidence can test whether the most likely end-state is not just “managed” in the abstract, but a **specific southern/Omani corridor with regulated traffic, mining risk outside the main lane, and limited pilot flows before wider normalization**.

Findings

1. **As of 9 June 2026, commercial vessels were already using a specific workaround route: south of the normal TSS, through Omani territorial waters.** JMIC Update 056 states that “Strait of Hormuz traffic remains significantly reduced, with commercial vessels continuing to route south of the TSS via Omani territorial waters.” The same update adds that “mining in and near the TSS remains a threat, and GNSS interference is consistent” [1]. This is a concrete operational fact not captured in detail in the current report. It suggests the practical end-form of reopening may center on a southern/Omani corridor rather than an immediate return to standard prewar routing [1].
2. **The UN Secretary-General explicitly described the Strait’s maritime corridor as a pre-existing joint Oman–Iran mechanism established in 1968.** In the April 2026 Security Council meeting, the Secretary-General said that the maritime corridor in

the Strait of Hormuz, established in 1968 and jointly operated by Oman and Iran, is “a mandatory mechanism” under the International Convention for the Safety of Life at Sea [2]. This is important because it gives a legal-institutional basis for an Oman-linked reopening format. It supports the idea that a resolution could take the form of restoring or adapting an existing corridor regime, rather than inventing a wholly new architecture [2].

3. The current operating picture therefore points to a geographically asymmetric reopening, with Omani waters likely serving as the first durable safe lane.

Combining JMIC’s report of current routing south of the TSS in Omani waters [1] with Oman’s official statement that it is working on “safe passage arrangements” [3], the evidence indicates that Muscat is not only a mediator but the state most directly associated with the route vessels are already using. This does not prove a final agreement, but it does objectively strengthen the case that early reopening will likely be **channelized and Oman-centered** rather than evenly spread across all traditional navigation lanes [1][3].

4. Mining risk appears to be concentrated enough to shape route design, not just overall risk perception. JMIC’s wording that “mining in and near the TSS remains a threat” [1], together with prior reporting that even limited mine activity could sharply constrain traffic and escort capacity [4], suggests that mine risk is not just a background hazard; it is influencing which lanes are used. The implication is that “reopening” will probably mean reopening of **specific verified lanes**, not of the entire Strait in a normal commercial sense [1][4].

5. GNSS interference remains a separate operational barrier that would slow normalization even if a security deal is signed. JMIC’s 9 June update says GNSS interference remains consistent in the Strait area [1]. This is an objective technical constraint on navigation and convoy management. It implies that even with lower missile or mine risk, shipping may still require route controls, naval guidance, or pilotage-like procedures until electronic interference subsides [1].

6. This corridor geometry helps explain why selective transits have been possible without broad reopening. Existing research already established that only a small number of vessels had crossed since early May and that two India-bound LPG tankers crossed in late March [5][6]. The new JMIC routing detail adds a mechanism: vessels can transit in a constrained southern lane under exceptional arrangements while the main TSS area remains mined or otherwise operationally degraded [1][5][6]. That supports a phased scenario in which pilot traffic expands before standard commercial routing returns.

7. **The physical form of reopening may therefore be narrower than the phrase “Strait reopens” suggests.** Verified evidence now supports distinguishing at least three nautical states:
8. **State A:** near-closure with exceptional transits only;
9. **State B:** limited corridor operations via Omani waters south of the TSS, with persistent mining and GNSS threats near standard lanes;
10. **State C:** broader restoration of normal TSS usage and commercial navigation patterns. JMIC evidence indicates the current situation is closest to State B for a small number of vessels, even though commercial throughput remains severely depressed [1]. This strengthens the report’s broader conclusion that the blockade’s end is likely to be staged.
11. **For scenario design, the new evidence most strongly strengthens the “negotiated maritime security deal” and “frozen partial closure” scenarios.**
12. It strengthens the **negotiated/Omani corridor** scenario because a practical Omani-water routing pattern already exists and because the UN has referenced a joint Oman–Iran corridor structure [1][2][3].
13. It also strengthens the **frozen partial closure** scenario because use of a southern workaround lane could persist for some time without restoring normal TSS operations or pre-crisis volumes [1].
14. It is less supportive of a clean “imposed reopening” interpretation, because even if force cleared one route, broader navigational normalization would still depend on demining, deconfliction, and reduction of GNSS interference [1][4].
15. **Facts vs inference**
16. **Verified facts:** JMIC said on 9 June that traffic remained significantly reduced and was routing south of the TSS via Omani territorial waters, with mining near the TSS and persistent GNSS interference [1]. The UN Secretary-General said the maritime corridor in the Strait was established in 1968 and jointly operated by Oman and Iran [2]. Oman’s Foreign Ministry said it was working on safe-passage arrangements [3].
17. **Analyst inference:** because existing traffic is already being funneled through Omani waters and because the UN referenced a pre-existing joint corridor framework, the likeliest practical form of any near-term reopening is a **regulated Omani-linked southern transit corridor**, not an immediate return to ordinary bidirectional commercial traffic across all standard lanes [1][2][3].

Why this angle matters for the core question

The question is not only **when** the blockade ends, but **in what form**. This additional research shows that the form is likely to be **spatially specific**: a reopening could begin as a narrow, monitored corridor in or alongside Omani waters south of the normal TSS, while mined or electronically disrupted areas remain only partially usable. That makes the likely end-state more concrete than the current report's generic "managed corridor" language. It also supports longer timelines from political agreement to full pre-February-2026 throughput, because restoring the entire navigational system is a bigger task than simply allowing some ships through [1][2][3][4].

Sources:

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